

CONTINUED ON >> P4

CJP march violence: 5 FIRs filed, police probe larger conspiracy

PRAMOD KUMAR SINGH
■ New Delhi

After violence broke out during the Cockroach Janata Party (CJP)'s march from Jantar Mantar to Parliament, Delhi Police filed five First Information Reports (FIRs) on Tuesday. Police also began investigating whether the unrest was part of a larger plan to disrupt the city's peace.

The FIRs were filed against unknown people at Parliament Street, Barakhamba, and Connaught Place police stations for rioting, damaging property, and assaulting public servants. Police said they will review CCTV footage and other electronic evidence to identify those involved. More FIRs could be filed if new details come up.

A senior police official said they have begun investigating

whether the violence was part of a broader plan to disrupt peace and order in the city. The investigation is looking at all available evidence, including electronic records, to identify those responsible and determine what happened.

Police said clashes began on Monday when thousands of protesters gathered at Jantar Mantar and tried to march to Parliament, ignoring warnings. As they attempted to cross barricades near Parliament Street, Janpath, Shastri Bhawan, and Connaught Place, some protesters threw stones, damaged vehicles, and turned violent. Security forces used batons and tear gas to break up the crowd and stop the march.

According to police, more than 118 officers, including senior staff, were injured, and about 15 to 20 Government

vehicles were damaged.

Around 70 protesters were detained at different locations. Hospital records showed about 60 protesters were also injured, and more than 170 people, including both protesters and police, were treated at hospitals like Ram Manohar Lohia Hospital for bruises, head injuries, and other wounds. One woman protester was reported to be in critical condition. Delhi Police shared videos showing alleged stone-pelting near Connaught Place. Officials said the police acted professionally to keep order and denied using too much force or assaulting anyone, including women protesters and people linked to hunger strikers.

The CJP and protesters accused the police of brutality, saying they used batons without reason, attacked peaceful demonstrators, and



Police personnel stop Cockroach Janata Party (CJP) supporters as they raise slogans during a protest march at Sansad Marg in New Delhi on Monday

used too much force on students and women. They said several protesters, including women, were hurt and claimed that officials took

down the protest stage at Jantar Mantar. CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke said the group would keep protesting, apologised to those who were

injured, and promised better protection for future participants. Sonam Wangchuk said these events were why he would not stop the protest.

There are different stories about how the violence started. Police said protesters threw stones and shared videos as proof.

Some protesters said the stones were already at the site and claimed the clashes began because of police actions. Police also said stones appeared to come from both sides in some places, and the investigation will determine what really happened.

After the incidents, Delhi Police filed five FIRs on Tuesday against unknown people. The cases registered at Parliament Street, Barakhamba, and Connaught Place police stations include charges under the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita for rioting, stone-pelting, vandalism, property damage, and assaulting or obstructing public servants. More cases may be filed if needed, sources said.

The CJP is calling for education reforms and an investigation into alleged police excesses, while officials are focused on maintaining public order and investigating illegal acts during the march. The investigation into Monday's violence and any possible conspiracy is still going on. Police have asked people not to share unverified information and to help keep the peace.

The CJP is a satirical youth group founded by Abhijeet Dipke. Since early June 2026, they have protested at Jantar Mantar with student groups over exam paper leaks, grading issues, and student deaths linked to academic stress. Their demands include the resignation of Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan, greater accountability from officials, and compensation for affected families.

Despite crackdown, protesters rebuild stage, tents overnight

ABHINAV KUMAR JHA
■ New Delhi

Sometime in the intervening night between Monday and Tuesday, young people returned to Jantar Mantar with their hands and put the protest back together. The police had dismantled the stage and removed the tents after the crackdown on Monday afternoon. By dawn on Tuesday, July 21, the tents were up again. By 11:30 am, the CJP posted a photograph from the site that needed no caption beyond the words it carried: "Jantar Mantar Is Again Packed. The more you suppress us, the more we will rise."

The Cockroach Janata Party on Tuesday vowed to continue its protest at Delhi's Jantar Mantar, a day after police used force to stop protesters marching towards Parliament and dismantled the protest site.



Cockroach Janata Party (CJP) supporters gather during a protest at Jantar Mantar, in New Delhi

Protesters began returning to Jantar Mantar early Tuesday after the platform called on supporters to continue the agitation.

In the morning, a group of young supporters narrated their experiences to Dipke, alleging that police personnel without name tags had

beaten up the protesters, including women, and called them "terrorists". Dipke was seen folding his hands and apologising to them.

The protest site remained packed through the afternoon as students, joined by parents and supporters, raised slogans over the

alleged irregularities in the NEET-UG examination and reiterated their demand for Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan's resignation. Many protesters said Monday's confrontation with the security personnel had failed to deter them and instead drawn

more people to the movement.

Delhi University student Sakshi Chanda, who participated in Monday's march to Parliament, alleged that the police action had only intensified the protest. "The kind of police brutality we witnessed yesterday only strengthened our resolve. We have come back because this movement has been built through the sacrifices of so many. We cannot allow that to go in vain. We will continue until our voices are heard," she said.

Standing beside her, Chanda's mother said parents had a responsibility to stand with students. "I came here today because this is about the future of our children. If we do not stand with them now, who will? They are asking questions about their education and careers, and they deserve to be heard," she said.

Prepared for tear gas: Protesters turn up in swimming goggles, N95 masks at Jantar Mantar

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

On Tuesday, several protesters at Jantar Mantar came carrying swimming goggles, N95 masks and helmets after watching videos of Monday's tear gas clashes circulate on social media. The protective gear stood out almost as much as the placards.

Some protesters returned wearing the same goggles and masks they had used during Monday's clashes, while many others bought them overnight after watching videos of the previous day's events on social media.

Tear gas shells were lobbed and lathi rain came down on protesters at Parliament Street, Patel Chowk and Rail Bhawan during Monday's march as slogans demanding accountability mixed with screams from those affected by the tear gas and police action.



Cockroach Janata Party founder (CJP) supporters raise slogans as they stage a protest at Jantar Mantar in New Delhi

The first-time protesters said Instagram reels, X posts and WhatsApp texts became their guide after videos from Monday's clashes began circulating online.

The advice was simple and repeated across platforms: wear swimming goggles to protect the eyes, put on an N95 mask, carry a damp towel to cover the face, wear full-sleeved clothes to reduce skin irrita-

tion and, if possible, use a helmet in case of a lathi-charge.

Instead of discussing slogans or speeches, many young protesters exchanged tips on what had worked the previous day. Some showed friends how tightly an N95 mask should fit, while others adjusted each other's goggles or reminded them to keep their towels wet.

Hardik, a 22-year-old from

Delhi, adjusted the goggles hanging around his neck before pulling his N95 mask snugly over his face. He said he had worn the same goggles and mask during Monday's march and did not think twice before carrying them again.

"The tear gas was much stronger than I expected. Even after we moved away, we could still feel it. Yesterday taught us that the goggles and mask have to fit tightly. Even a small gap lets the gas in. These goggles really helped me, so I brought them again today. I bought them yesterday from Zepto," he said. Despite Monday's clashes, Hardik said he never considered staying away. "I came yesterday, I came back today, and I'll keep coming back. If students are raising questions about education, I want to stand with them. It is our fundamental right," he said.

Paintbrushes, pop culture and protest: Jantar Mantar turns canvas of dissent

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Wielding paintbrushes as they turned everyday images and objects into biting satire, the protesting students at the Jantar Mantar have channelled their creativity into their agitation against alleged paper leaks, transforming the venue into an open-air gallery where art has become a language of dissent.

In the backdrop of fervent speeches and sloganeering, hand-drawn illustrations, quirky costumes, poetic placards, caricatures, cartoons and even memes lie strewn around the venue as a generation turns to creativity to amplify its demands.

One of the most striking displays was a sanitary napkin carrying the handwritten message, "...even this pad doesn't leak," in a satirical reference to the alleged examination paper leaks.

Nearby stood a recreation of the iconic "three wise monkeys" — one covering the eyes with a bandage, another putting a lock over its mouth, while the third pours oil into its ears.

The captions read, "Patti chot pe lagao, aankho pe nahi (Bandage wound, not the eyes)", "Taala darwaze pe lagao,



muh pe nahi (Lock doors, not the mouth)" and "Tel kaano me nahi, baalo me daalo (Put oil on your hair, not in your ears)," urging authorities not to ignore, suppress or remain deaf to students' concerns. History and revolution too found expression through art.

Hand-painted portraits of Dr BR Ambedkar were displayed alongside posters of Cuban revolutionary Che Guevara. Floral designs dotted the protest venue, while the artworks — most of them fashioned out of mundane objects, with defiant strokes of paint and sketch pen on recycled paper — added a distinctive youthful vibrancy.

Historical figures came alive through cosplay. Several participants came dressed as Mahatma Gandhi, with one of the portrayals featuring blood-like tears streaming from Gandhi's eyes.

Bollywood dialogues and popular culture featured prominently in placards. One adapted a well-known dialogue from Rogit Shetty's 'Golmaal 3' to read, "Jaldi resignation do, subah Panvel jana hai (Resign quickly, got to leave for Panvel tomorrow)," while another borrowed the title "Tu Jhoothi Main Makkaar" to caption the caricatures of two political leaders.

Another poster depicted a map of India like a biscuit being dipped into a cup of tea. "I wanted to show how the country is being treated. It took me two days to complete this poster. I carried it during Monday's march and have brought it here again today because I want more people to see the message," Hardik, a protester, said.

Pointing to a scarf featuring the Strawhat Pirate skull from the popular Japanese manga and anime series "One Piece", protester Shivangi said, "This is a warning sign. It's our way of saying that something is seriously wrong and cannot be ignored."



Ministry of Housing
and Urban Affairs
Government of India



एन बी सी सी
NBCC
A Navratna CPSE

Sale of Residential Apartments
Through e-Auction

Once-in-a-Lifetime
Opportunity to Own
Your Dream Home at
Prime Location

Avenue Towers

EXCLUSIVITY. TRANQUILITY & ULTIMATED LUXURY

Near Leela Palace Hotel Chanakyapuri, New Delhi

PRICE
STARTING
FROM
₹ 15.75 CR



Gym



Landscape Terrace



Indoor Games



Outdoor Pool



Scan
for
location



Premium
4 BHK
Residences



Landscaped
Greens &
Social Spaces



Swimming
Pool &
Gymnasium



Community
Facilities



Sports &
Recreation
Amenities



Children's
Play Area



Library, Reading
& Co-working
Spaces



Security, Power
Backup & Modern
Infrastructure



Scan
to view
brochure

Last Date of receiving EMD: 30.07.2026

Date of e-Auction: 31.07.2026

RERA Registration Number: DLRERA2026P0010 | Weblink: <https://erera.co.in/teradelhiindex/PublicView/RegisteredProjectDetail>

NBCC (INDIA) LIMITED
(A Government of India Enterprise)
NBCC Bhawan, Lodhi Road, New Delhi - 110003

Call @ 8527136569, 9899179426,
8168059012, 8527509652
www.nbccindia.in

IN FOCUS



Commuters make their way through a damaged stretch of the Dehradun-Mussoorie road after heavy monsoon rains in Mussoorie (PTI)

Fresh floods in Arunachal, rivers in spate in Assam

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

At least six people died due to rain-related incidents in the northeast where floods have damaged train tracks, agricultural land and public utilities, while heavy showers in Himachal Pradesh and Jammu severely disrupted normal life.

In Himachal Pradesh, six houses were swept away due to a cloudburst but authorities said there were no casualties. All schools and colleges were shut in Kangra, Mandi, and Sirmour districts on Tuesday in view of a red alert by the meteorological department for heavy rain. Intermittent rain forced the authorities to shut all educational institu-



People move to a safer place in a flood-affected area following incessant heavy rainfall, at Phulpanisiga, Assam (PTI)

tions also in Theog of Shimla, Salooni of Chamba, and Nirmand of Kullu districts.

The old Hindustan-Tibet road (National Highway 5) was closed for vehicular traffic following landslides at two places in Kinnaur district, officials said. Heavy rains lashed large parts of Jammu region as rescue

teams continued their search for seven persons reported missing in the worst-hit Poonch and Rajouri districts.

At least 23 people have died and seven others are missing in rain-related incidents in Poonch, Rajouri and Doda districts since Sunday. In Assam, one

person in Charaideo district died due to the floods, taking the toll in such rain-related deaths to 11.

Several major rivers were flowing above the danger level in different parts of the state, with some of the water bodies having breached the "extreme flood" level.

Rescue operations were being carried out by multiple agencies.

Train services remained affected for the second day as floodwaters inundated tracks in parts of Upper Assam, with the Northeast Frontier Railway (NFR) cancelling, short-terminating or diverting several trains and also announcing special trains for stranded passengers.

IIT-Roorkee advises students, staff against political posts

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Indian Institute of Technology (IIT)-Roorkee has warned its students and staff against using social media to show affinity to "any political movement like the current one."

The advisory issued on Monday cited the institute's rules barring students from making any statement which can "embarrass relations between the institute and Government."

While the fresh advisory created furore on social media with several users terming it a "gag order", the institute insisted that it is in accordance with existing rules and should not be viewed out of context. "It has been noticed on social media platforms like Instagram and Facebook that some of the campus inmates have shown



their affinity with political movements like the one currently in public utterance and criticism.

All the students, employees, and stakeholders are politely reminded herewith that IIT admitted students or appointed staff are to provide for instructions, research and for advancement of learning and dissemination of knowledge in engineering, technology, science and arts," the IIT registrar said in the July 20 advisory.

LG Sandhu attends 100th martyrdom anniversary of Teja Singh Samundri

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ New Delhi

Delhi Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu on Monday attended a Vishesh Kirtan Darbar at Gurdwara Sri Guru Singh Sabha in Janakpuri to mark the 100th martyrdom anniversary of Sardar Teja Singh Samundri. On the occasion, the LG recalled a figure who established a girls' school in 1917 despite not having passed Class 6 himself, personally led Dalit residents to draw water from a village well from which they had been barred, and died in Lahore Jail in 1926 at the age of 43 after refusing to apologise for his release.

Delhi Minister Ashish Sood also attended the programme. Gurbani Kirtan was rendered by Bhai



Surjeet Singh, Hazoori Raagi, and Bhai Jaskaran Singh of Patiala, followed by Ardaas.

Addressing the gathering, Sandhu recalled that of 53 Sikh

leaders arrested and jailed in Lahore, only 11 refused to apologise and secure their release. Teja Singh Samundri was among them. He died in Lahore Jail under cir-

cumstances that Master Tara Singh had described as mysterious. Bhai Vir Singh called him a supreme, holy martyr. Master Tara Singh described him as a complete Sikh, remarking that his entire life was the life of a martyr.

Sandhu noted that Teja Singh Samundri Hall in the Darbar Sahib complex remains, to this day, the only building in that complex named after an ordinary Sikh, a distinction that reflects the singular esteem in which he continues to be held by the Panth.

On his contributions to social reform, Sandhu recalled that in 1921-22, Teja Singh Samundri personally led Dalit residents of Sarhali to draw water from a village well from which they had

historically been excluded, drinking the water himself first. This act of deliberate equality, Sandhu said, came decades before such causes gained wider currency in Indian public life.

On education, Sandhu noted that although he had not passed Class 6 himself, Teja Singh Samundri established schools in Sarhali and Samundri in 1917, including a girls' school. From those institutions have since emerged five Generals of the Indian Army, two Vice-Chancellors, and several Olympians.

On women's franchise, Sandhu recalled that Sikhs exercised their voting rights for the first time in the 1926 SGPC election, with women voting as early as 1926, a

year ahead of Great Britain, where women first voted in 1927.

On his role in the freedom movement, Sandhu said Teja Singh Samundri was among the first to court arrest during the Shaheedi Morchas between 1914 and 1920, and was chosen by the Sangat to lead the Kar Seva at Darbar Sahib in 1923.

He recounted an episode from the Guru Ka Bagh Morcha, where scholar Professor Ruchi Ram Sahni had asked how the agitation could be called successful. Teja Singh Samundri had pointed to the spontaneous support extended by the Hindu community of Amritsar in arranging mats and supplies for protesters, citing it as an example of Hindu-Sikh unity of that era.

Govt schools without permanent buildings to be provided land within six months: Bihar CM

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Patna

Bihar Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary on Tuesday said Government schools in the state that lack permanent buildings would be provided land for their own premises within six months.

The remarks came after several MLAs cutting across party lines highlighted the poor condition of Government schools in the state during the Question Hour in the Assembly.

They said that the buildings of a large number of schools either have no buildings or have fallen into disrepair.



Bihar Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary addresses the gathering during the distribution of appointment letters to newly selected candidates under the Rural Livelihood Promotion Society (JEEVKA) in Patna (PTI)

Intervening in the discussion, the chief minister said, "Government schools operating without permanent buildings will be provided land for their own premises within six months." JD(U) MLA

Manjeet Kumar Singh said 2,294 primary and middle schools in the state do not have their own buildings while 703 high schools and 3,000 higher secondary schools in 26 districts are

functioning without their own buildings. Education Minister Mithilesh Tiwari responded that 2,276 primary schools and 792 higher secondary schools in the state lack their own buildings, but the Government is working towards addressing the issue.

RJD MLA Kumar Sarvjeet said that approximately 40 per cent of school buildings in Bihar had collapsed, forcing schools to relocate to other villages. He asked the Government whether the department had ever reviewed the number of school buildings in each panchayat that had fallen into disrepair or collapsed.

Udmaroo bridge over Shayok river in Ladakh's Nubra inaugurated

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ Leh

Ladakh Lieutenant Governor Vinai Kumar Saxena on Tuesday inaugurated the ₹27.18-crore Udmaroo Bridge over Shayok River in Nubra district, improving connectivity across the region and providing year-round access to the Buddhist pilgrimage site of Sham Gombo.

The bridge will reduce the travel distance between Udmaroo and Hundri villages and Terchey and Skuru villages by nearly 35 kms, drastically reducing travel time and providing seamless all-weather connectivity, an official said.

The bridge will also improve access across Nubra and provide uninterrupted connectivity to Sham Gombo (Yarma Gonbo), an important Buddhist pilgrimage site, thereby strengthening religious tourism and socio-economic develop-



ment in the region. The bridge, a modern three-span (3x80 metres) Truss System Bridge with 70R loading capacity and approximately 230 metres of approach roads, which has been executed under the Special Development Package (SDP) of the UT Administration, is expected to directly benefit nearly 1,000 residents living in the surrounding villages.

Opposition leaders detained for protesting...

While Rahul was put in detention at the Chhatrasal Stadium, Priyanka Gandhi was detained at Mandir Marg police station and other MPs at Kingsway Camp in north Delhi area. Late evening, Congress Parliamentary Party Chairperson Sonia Gandhi reached Mandir Marg police station.

The Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha could be seen lying on the ground and resisting as security personnel tried to pick him up. Sources said he was hurt in the process. An aide said he suffered an injury below the eye. In a follow up statement after his detention, Rahul said the fight for justice for students will neither stop nor be halted despite the pressures exerted by the Union Governments. On the other hand several opposition leaders including NCP (SP) president Sharad Pawar and AAP chief Arvind Kejriwal visited the Cockroach Janta Party's protest site at Jantar Mantar.

Pawar, accompanied by party MP Supriya Sule, met injured protesters and members of the movement and condemned the police action during Monday's attempted march to Parliament.

Among other political leaders who visited the protest site were Shiv Sena (UBT) MPs Sanjay Raut and Arvind Sawant, Rajya Sabha MP Mahua Maji, AAP leader Gopal Rai, Kerala Congress (M) leader Jose K Mani, and a delegation of parliamentarians from Left parties.

Wangchuk gets HC relief, moved out of Safdarjung

"The irony of the situation today is that those around him want him out irrespective of his health," Mehta added.

"We will not go into all that. Do not drag the court into all that," Chief Justice Upadhyaya responded.

"We accordingly direct that the husband of the appellant shall immediately be shifted to Medanta Hospital, Gurugram. The director of Medanta Hospital shall form a team of doctors having requisite expertise, which shall constantly monitor the medical condition of the husband of the appellant and shall also administer medication as may be required in their opinion in terms of the accepted medical norms and protocols, to which the husband of the appellant shall abide," the court ordered. "We are concerned with (Wangchuk's)

fundamental rights. Nothing to do with all that is going on," the bench remarked, as it closed the proceedings. It also said that Angmo will be permitted to visit Wangchuk as and when she desires.

In her appeal, Angmo contended that the single judge's Sunday order illegally confined Wangchuk to Safdarjung Hospital without any arrest and effectively directed that neither the activist nor his wife had decisive authority in determining his medical treatment.

Angmo's senior counsel had said Wangchuk was picked up from Jantar Mantar on July 18 and taken to Safdarjung Hospital without any consultation and in the absence of any medical emergency, purportedly in line with the bench's July 16 order asking the authorities to monitor his health and medically intervene if necessary. Asserting the right to accept medical treatment or oversight at a hospital of one's choice and bodily autonomy, Sibal had said the sequence of events had resulted in a "loss of trust", and Wangchuk, who was not under any detention, should be permitted to be discharged from Safdarjung Hospital.

Police register six FIRs, detain 100 in CJP...

The FIR states that the accused allegedly formed an unlawful assembly, disrupted public order, obstructed Government officials, took part in violence and damaged public property.

The principal FIR registered at Parliament Street Police Station invokes multiple provisions of the BNS, including those dealing with unlawful assembly, rioting, criminal conspiracy, assault on public servants, obstruction of official duty, acts endangering human life and common intention. The case also includes Section 25(1AB) of the Arms Act and Section 3 of the PDPP Act. Another FIR was registered against unidentified people for violence, stone-pelting, and vandalism of police vehicles near Regal Cinema at the Outer Circle of Connaught Place during the march, the source added.

Yet another FIR relates to the alleged unauthorised use of a drone in the New Delhi district during the Parliament session. CJP's official social media handle uploaded the drone footage. Another concerns an alleged conspiracy behind the violence, with investigators claiming to have recovered crucial evidence indicating that the unrest may have been planned. Two other FIRs pertain to obstruction of Government work, assault on

police personnel, vandalism and damage to public property. Police are also preparing two additional FIRs invoking provisions related to assault, taking the law into one's own hands and other offences under the BNS.

Another FIR pertains to alleged stone-pelting and vandalism near Regal Cinema in Connaught Place, where protesters allegedly attacked police personnel and damaged several police vehicles. Investigators are examining CCTV footage, drone recordings, mobile phone videos and social media content to identify those involved. A senior police officer said further legal action would be taken against anyone found responsible for assaulting police personnel, damaging Government property or disturbing public order.

Following Monday's clashes, in which Delhi Police said more than 118 security personnel were injured, and over 20 police vehicles were damaged, security has been heightened across New Delhi and other sensitive districts with additional police and paramilitary deployment, multi-layered barricades and intensified vehicle checks.

Delhi Police underestimated the...

Most of the crowd were students and youngsters. They broke through barricades and got close to the Press Club and Parliament, which led to baton charge and the use of tear gas by the police.

The police claims protesters engaged in stone pelting, damaging 15 to 20 Government vehicles while creating a law-and-order problem. Delhi Police reported 118 personnel injured, including senior officers and women constables.

The march was expected, but the size and speed of the crowd took the police by surprise. Reports say Delhi Police were "outnumbered and taken aback" when thousands reached near Parliament, calling it an "unprecedented turn."

Sources said Delhi Police were prepared and aware, but they underestimated how strongly the protest would resonate and how determined the crowd would be. Intelligence probably tracked the main agitators and planned actions, but missed or downplayed the wider anger among students tired of exam scams and official indifference.

Monday showed there was a big difference between what was expected and how many people actually turned up. It proved that force alone cannot quell frustration stemming from long-

standing problems. The protesters were much harder to stop than expected.

Mother, kids killed in Delhi flat fire

Neighbours noticed smoke emerging from the building's third floor and several people went to help extinguish the fire and rescue those trapped inside. A relative, Devender Sharma, rushed to the house after learning about the incident. He said, "I have no idea how the fire started. We were told that the fire was confined to one room."

Police said preliminary inquiry revealed that Akansha Sharma had been undergoing treatment for a mental health condition since 2020. At the time of the incident, other family members, including her husband Mohit Sharma, an advocate, were present on the second floor of the building, police said. The District Crime Team and the Forensic Science Laboratory (FSL) examined the spot. Investigators said no signs of foul play have emerged so far, though all possible angles are being examined. The exact cause of the fire is yet to be determined and will be established after a detailed forensic examination, police said. Authorities have informed the victims' family and are extending assistance. Police added that the investigation is ongoing and further details will be shared once the cause of the blaze is established.

MP Assembly passes UCC amid Opposition uproar

When the House reconvened, Congress MLA Bala Bachchan questioned the Government's intent behind introducing the legislation in its present form. Opposition leaders, including Umang Singhar, Atif Aqueel and Arif Masood, criticised the Bill, describing it as politically motivated. They argued that the Government was using the legislation to further its political agenda rather than addressing pressing issues affecting the State.

The Congress also invoked Article 29 of the Constitution, which protects the cultural and educational rights of minorities. Opposition members contended that the proposed law required broader consultations to ensure that constitutional safeguards and the interests of different communities were adequately protected.

Despite the Opposition's continued protests and objections, the Government proceeded with the

legislative process. Speaker Narendra Singh Tomar continued the proceedings amid the disruptions and declared the Bill passed by the Assembly. With the Assembly's approval secured, the Uniform Civil Code Bill will now be sent to the Governor for assent. Once the Governor grants approval, the legislation will be notified in the Official Gazette, after which it will come into force in Madhya Pradesh. According to the Government's roadmap, the law is expected to be implemented later this month.

Sikkim tunnel collapse claims 10 lives

A total of 27 people, including project officials and workers, were trapped inside the ADIT-3 tunnel of the NHPC Teesta Stage VI Hydroelectric Project at Samardung in Jhollungey after a landslide blocked its entrance and triggered a suspected gas leak on Monday. The rescue operation had been complicated by the presence of gas inside the tunnel, with several personnel experiencing dizziness and losing consciousness while attempting to reach the trapped workers, they said.

Sikkim Chief Minister, Prem Singh Tamang said he was closely monitoring the ongoing rescue operation. The CM said Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Union Home Minister Amit Shah spoke with him and enquired about the rescue operations. "My heartfelt condolences go to the families of the workers, who have lost their lives. In this hour of grief, the thoughts and prayers of the entire state are with the bereaved families, and we stand firmly by them during this difficult time," a statement from the CM read. It added, "His (PM) words of concern and compassion for the affected workers and their families, along with his assurance of every possible assistance from the Government of India, have provided immense strength and reassurance to the people of Sikkim during this difficult hour."

The teams of the Namchi district administration, Sikkim State Disaster Management Authority (SSDMA), Sikkim Police, State Disaster Response Force (SDRF), Fire and Emergency Services, and the National Disaster Response Force (NDRF) from Pakyong and Siliguri, along with other specialised agencies, were working tirelessly to recover the bodies of the remaining workers trapped inside the tunnel, Tamang said. The CM said he has directed the authorities to provide every possible assistance, expedite the rescue efforts, and ensure that the highest standards of safety are strictly maintained throughout the operation.

Opposition leaders back student protests

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Several Opposition leaders, including NCP (SP) president Sharad Pawar and AAP chief Arvind Kejriwal, visited the Cockroach Janta Party's protest site at Jantar Mantar on Tuesday, a day after the police crackdown on its 'Sansad Chalo' march, and extended support to the agitation over alleged irregularities in competitive examinations.

Pawar, accompanied by party MP Supriya Sule, met injured protesters and members of the movement and condemned the police action during Monday's attempted march to Parliament.

Among other political leaders who visited the protest site were Shiv Sena (UBT) MPs Sanjay Raut and Arvind Sawant, Rajya Sabha MP Mahua Maji, AAP leader Gopal Rai, Kerala Congress (M) leader Jose K Mani, and a delegation of parliamentarians from Left parties.

According to a statement issued by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP), Pawar said the voices of students demanding a fair and transparent



NCP (SP) President Sharad Pawar interacts with CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke as he visits Jantar Manta on Tuesday PTI

examination system could not be silenced through force and assured that the NCP (SP) would continue to support the movement both inside and outside Parliament.

"The Nationalist Congress Party stands firmly with the students. We will raise these issues in Parliament and continue supporting this movement until justice is delivered and accountability is fixed," he said.

Earlier in the day, Kejriwal

visited Ram Manohar Lohia Hospital and met students injured in Monday's police action. He said one of the injured protesters, a young woman, continued to remain in the intensive care unit.

"I pray that the girl recovers soon and is able to return home. I am trying to get in touch with her parents," Kejriwal said.

The former Delhi chief minister later visited Jantar Mantar and interacted with protesters who had returned to the site

despite the injuries they suffered during the police action.

Raut and Sawant also met the protesters and expressed support for the agitation.

According to the CJP, Raut said, "The fire lit at Jantar Mantar will not be extinguished. We will join the hunger strike if needed."

Separately, a delegation of Left MPs comprising CPI(M) Rajya Sabha members John Brittas, AA Rahim and V Sivadasan, CPI Rajya Sabha MP P Sandosh Kumar, CPI(M)

Lok Sabha MPs Amra Ram and S Venkatesan, along with Kerala Congress (M) leader Mani, visited the protest site and demanded that Union Home Minister Amit Shah make a statement in Parliament on the police action against protesters.

The visits came a day after thousands of protesters gathered at Jantar Mantar for the CJP's march to Parliament despite heavy security deployment and prohibitory orders under Section 163 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita. Police used tear gas shells and batons to stop the protesters.

Opposition parties have demanded a discussion in Parliament on the incident.

The CJP-led agitation began on June 20. The Abhijeet Dipke-led outfit is demanding accountability over alleged irregularities in competitive examinations, reforms in the education system and the resignation of Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan.

Activist Sonam Wangchuk, who was forcefully shifted by the Delhi Police to Safdarjung Hospital on July 18, has continued his fast from the hospital.

89 treated, 1 in ICU after police action on CJP protest

KHUSHI MEHROTRA
■ New Delhi

In the aftermath of violent clashes between participants of the CJP's "Sansad Chalo" march and the Delhi Police, RML Hospital continued to be the focus. Numerous injured individuals received medical treatment, with one young woman remaining in critical condition in the ICU.

Hospital sources informed *The Pioneer* that a total of 89 protesters, with injuries ranging from minor to moderate severity, were treated and discharged between Monday and Tuesday afternoon, following police intervention. An eyewitness reported that multiple ambulances arrived at the emergency department late Monday evening, observing at least three individuals with serious head injuries being admitted.

A senior hospital official indicated that most of those treated were student protesters; however, their exact ages and backgrounds could not be precisely determined. By Tuesday evening, three indi-



viduals remained hospitalised: a Delhi Police officer, a Rapid Action Force (RAF) personnel, and a 23-year-old protester named Sakshi, whose condition was classified as serious but stable.

Security on the ICU ward was substantially increased, with the area cordoned off. Media personnel were denied access to Sakshi's family and the ward itself.

According to hospital and family reports, Sakshi likely experienced asphyxia during a stampede-like incident triggered when tear gas shells were fired, causing protesters to flee. A family member, who wished to remain anonymous, reported that Sakshi sustained

injuries to her face, chest, and neck. She attended the protest with her cousin, who also suffered a leg injury.

The family member stated, "After tear gas shells were fired, the crowd began to run. She was caught in the rush and sustained severe injuries. She is on a ventilator but responding to treatment."

Residing in Chhattarpur Extension, Sakshi is pursuing an Advanced Diploma in Computer Applications (ADCA). Sources also indicated that she has been undergoing treatment for tuberculosis over the past several months. Hospital authorities have issued no official medical bulletin regarding her condition.

CJP march: Delhi Police, students trade blame on violence

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Delhi Police faced criticism after several videos of protesters alleging excessive action against them surfaced on social media a day after the Cockroach Janta Party's (CJP) 'Sansad Chalo' march.

However, some videos also appeared to show police personnel being attacked by demonstrators.

A woman protester, an UPSC aspirant, said the police action had left her disillusioned.

"I am preparing for UPSC,

but after seeing the police, I no longer feel like continuing. How will I survive among them when they behave like this with students?" she said.

Another protester, breaking down in tears, said, "We are not criminals. We are here demanding a better education system. Who treats human beings like this?"

In another video, a protester alleged that a tear gas shell exploded near his feet. "Are we terrorists or what? Why is such action being taken against us? The police are supposed to help us," he said. A protester with an injured



leg alleged that the Government had failed to address their concerns. "Had the government shown even 20 per cent accountability, we

would not have been protesting. Because of their incompetence, we are facing such brutality," he said.

One purported video also

appeared to show a police official from the northeast district slapping a young woman protester.

Meanwhile, other videos showed police personnel being attacked during the clashes.

In one clip, an officer trying to stop protesters in Connaught Place fell during a scuffle, after which some protesters allegedly pulled his hair and attacked him. Another video showed a protester pulling off a police personnel's helmet during an argument.

According to Delhi Police,

more than 118 police personnel, including several senior officers, were injured and over 60 protesters sustained injuries after the CJP's protest march to Parliament, demanding Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan's resignation over alleged examination irregularities, turned violent in the New Delhi area on Monday.

In a statement, Delhi Police alleged that protesters displayed "unruly, aggressive and violent behaviour," attacked security personnel, and damaged Government vehicles and public property.



Delhi Police deny CJP claim of pellet gun use in march

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Delhi Police on Tuesday rejected CJP's allegation of use of pellet guns by its personnel against protesters during the "Chalo Sansad" march. Cockroach Janata Party spokesperson Saurav Das on Tuesday shared a video on X alleging that the police had fired pellet guns at peaceful protesters. The post also carried a video showing a man with perforations on his face that resembled having been inflicted by a pellet gun. "Fake News Alert," Delhi Police wrote on X in response. "Reports claiming that police forces are using pellet guns against peaceful protesters are completely false and misleading," the police said.

The force urged people not to share or circulate unverified content and advised the public to verify facts only through official sources before posting or forwarding information on social media. "Appropriate legal action will be taken against individuals found spreading rumours or misinformation," its post read.

In another post on social media, a user claimed that Rapid Action Force (RAP)

used a stun gun on the protesters. The police rebuffed this claim also.

"Reports claiming that the RAF used electric stun guns against protesters are completely false and misleading," they said.

Some videos showed police personnel being attacked during the clashes.

In one clip, an officer trying to stop protesters in Connaught Place fell during a scuffle, after which some protesters allegedly pulled his hair and attacked him. Another video showed a protester pulling off a police personnel's helmet during an argument.

According to Delhi Police, more than 118 police personnel, including several senior officers, were injured and over 60 protesters sustained injuries after the CJP's protest march to Parliament, demanding Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan's resignation over alleged examination irregularities, turned violent in the New Delhi area on Monday.

In a statement, Delhi Police alleged that protesters displayed "unruly, aggressive and violent behaviour," attacked security personnel, and damaged Government vehicles and public property.

Mumbai man sends food to CJP protesters at Jantar Mantar

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Protesters sitting at Jantar Mantar had a welcome visitor early Tuesday who came bearing food packets, all paid for.

A video clip, which has since gone viral, showed a delivery partner reaching the site where hundreds stay put amid heavy rain with packets of food ordered and paid for by a Mumbai resident.

Displaying the order details on his mobile phone, the man says the food was ordered by Anuj Rawat from Mumbai, Maharashtra, with instructions to distribute it to anyone hungry.

"Someone named Anuj Rawat from Mumbai, Maharashtra, ordered the food and asked us to distribute it to anyone hungry at Jantar Mantar. The payment has already been made



online," the delivery partner says in the video.

The clip has garnered widespread praise. Several users hailed the Mumbaikar's solidarity, while others commented that "humanity is not lost."

The video surfaced a day after thousands of protesters participating in the Cockroach Janta Party's Parliament march were subjected to a lathi charge and tear gas.

CJP march echoes 15 years of major Delhi protests

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The attempted march by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) supporters towards Parliament on Monday, leading to clashes with the police and detentions, brought back memories of similar mass protests over the last 15 years in the national Capital. These included the 2021 tractor rally on January 26, where protesting farmers breached security at the Red Fort and or the 2012 Nirbhaya agitation, where ordinary citizens reached the doors of Raisina Hill.

The 2021 Republic Day tractor rally was among the biggest protests to witness a march towards central Delhi. As part of the year-long agitation against the three farm laws, later scrapped, many farmers entered the capital with tractors on January 26 after assembling at the city's borders.

While the rally had been permitted on designated



routes, a section of the protesters breached barricades, deviated from the agreed routes and headed towards central Delhi, leading to clashes with police. Some protesters also entered the Red Fort complex and hoisted the Nishan Sahib and farmers' union flags from its ramparts. More than 300 police personnel were injured in the violence.

On Monday, Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) supporters carrying the tricolour raised

slogans and pushed through multiple police barricades while demanding the resignation of Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan over alleged paper leaks and examination irregularities. Police used force to stop the protesters from marching towards Parliament.

Attempts to march towards Parliament or other high-security areas in central Delhi have featured in several major protests over the years,

with demonstrators seeking to press their demands before the Government.

The preparations on the ground appeared to indicate that the police believed the protest march would fizzle out before noon. The area around Jantar Mantar was extensively barricaded. Initially, around 2,000 personnel were deployed.

The Home Ministry also seems to have believed that the protest would not sustain. The initial internet shutdown order was issued from 6 am to noon. However, as the situation spiralled out of control, with protesters breaking barricades and clashing with police, the internet shutdown was extended till 6 pm.

As the crowd swelled, the DMRC closed five metro stations, ostensibly to prevent more protesters from reaching the site. However, this created chaos and an unending agony for the thousands of office-goers and commuters who remained stuck for hours.

Bodies at the barricade: notes from Jantar Mantar student protest

SHATAKSHI SHELLY ■ New Delhi

On July 20, thousands of students converged on Jantar Mantar for CJP's "Chalo Sansad" march, demanding accountability from a Government that has spent years disclaiming responsibility for the state of the education system it presides over. What had begun as an orderly, almost procedural demonstration transformed by evening curdled into scenes of lathi charges, tear gas fired in sustained volleys, and crowds pressed against barricades with nowhere left to go.

I was there. What follows is my own account, alongside testimonies I gathered from four peers who were present at different points along the march route — Aditi, Vikram, Saira*, and Palak. Read together, their accounts do not converge on a single narrative so much as they triangulate one: a demonstration that was peaceful and self-policing until the state decided otherwise, and a use

of force so undifferentiated that it stopped distinguishing between protester and bystander, advance and retreat, dissent and simple presence.

The morning

We arrived early. The mood was determined but not adversarial; if anything, what struck me was how unremarkable it all felt. The police, for most of the morning, were genuinely courteous. There was no indication, yet, of where the day was headed.

By early afternoon, the heat had gotten to me. I started feeling unwell along with a few others, and we withdrew to recover. It was from where I was sitting — drained and trying to steady myself that news reached us of what was happening to the rest of our group: lathi charges, tear gas shells landing in the same stretch we'd occupied less than an hour before.

Aditi, a first-year student, was still in the crowd when



the police moved to push it back.

"They were trying to push us back with lathis, but there was no place to go," she said. "It just ended up hitting us, and we were being squashed against each other. You couldn't breathe, because the crowd was so thick, and when you turned your face to breathe upward, it was just tear gas and your eyes, face and throat started burning. It

was really horrible."

At one point, Aditi fell. "I thought I might die, because that's how stampedes happen," she said. What kept it from becoming one, by her own account, was the crowd's own restraint — the people around her were careful enough not to step on her, and she was able to get back up.

Vikram was elsewhere in the same crowd, said that

even though this issue doesn't affect him personally "I can't turn my back on an issue that affects lakhs of people, and a government that takes no accountability," he said. He described people bleeding from the head, every route blocked, tear gas on every side, and a question he kept returning to: why force, instead of dialogue?

Nothing in what he described suggested a target-

ed or discriminating dispersal. It was tear gas released indiscriminately into a packed, contained crowd that was the precise conditions under which a stampede became likely rather than merely possible. People were not being pushed back in any orderly sense. They were being trapped.

Saira left home at 8 a.m. and did not return until 10 that night. By the time things escalated, she said, tear gas was being dropped on both ends of the crowd simultaneously, front and back — collapsing whatever direction people might have retreated toward. People ended up colliding into one another simply trying to find space that no longer existed. In Connaught Place, she said, a tear gas shell was dropped even on people who were already retreating rather than advancing. This detail, if accurate, undercuts any reading of the response as a controlled attempt to disperse an advancing crowd.

She described Reserve Armed Forces personnel charging at bystanders, and said she watched around a dozen of them, in blue uniforms, beating three people at once. When police then charged toward her own group, they ran and tried to get off the street; shopkeepers locked their doors against them. "The employees of KFC were laughing at us and recording videos when we were pleading with them to let us in to get away from the personnel and the tear gas."

"Lathi charge is the new normal"

Palak, another protester I spoke to, was among the first people standing behind the barricades on Sansad Marg, and her account traces the same arc as mine: police cordial at first, and then, with little warning, tear gas fired at intervals of two to three minutes until a stampede broke out. Even then, she said, people were doing their best

to remain respectful of one another.

She and a friend were both hit by lathis, her friend repeatedly. She noted that police seemed, at moments, to go somewhat easier on women, though this held inconsistently: when a group of women told officers they were already leaving, "they still didn't stop."

By her count, (reported by Saira* as well) roughly ten rounds of tear gas were fired within eight minutes, some directed at people who were already running away. She saw one man beaten badly enough that his head split open; she and others were administering first aid to him when police moved in again, scattering everyone before they could finish. What has stayed with her most is the indiscriminate-ness of it; they were hitting people left and right, not caring if they were retreating. "It was a really sorry situation," she said.

States Focus



HARYANA'S CHIEF ELECTION OFFICER REVIEWS SIR'S PROGRESS

Haryana Chief Electoral Officer (CEO) A Sreenivas on Tuesday reviewed the progress of the ongoing Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls and directed district authorities to ensure that no eligible voter is left out of the revision exercise.

Chairing a video conference with deputy commissioners and election officials from all districts, Sreenivas reviewed the work of Booth Level Officers (BLOs), including the collection of enumeration forms, enrolment of eligible voters and identification of ineligible entries in the electoral rolls. Additional Chief Electoral Officers Ritu and Apurv, along with Joint Chief Electoral Officer Raj Kumar Lohan, attended the meeting from the New Civil Secretariat in Chandigarh. (PTI)



SUKHU ASKS WORKERS TO STRENGTHEN CONGRESS PARTY

Himachal Chief Minister Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu on Tuesday asked the Congress workers to remain united and strengthen the party's ideology while taking the State Government's policies and public welfare schemes to the people.

Sukhu's remarks came after launching the 'Chief Minister's Dialogue with Workers' programme for the Pachhad assembly constituency in Sirmaur district and the Chopal assembly constituency in Shimla district.

From his official residence, Oak Over, Shimla, Sukhu interacted with Congress workers from both constituencies, sought their feedback and discussed developmental works, a statement said.

He said that during the last three-and-a-half years, the State Government has launched several welfare schemes to ensure the well-being of the people, and every eligible person should receive their benefits.

Sukhu said the Congress Government inherited a deteriorated administrative system from the previous BJP Government, and that several measures have been taken since then to improve the system. (PTI)

FBI seeks Indian national Harmanveer Singh in drug probe

PRAMOD KUMAR SINGH
■ New Delhi

Following a major crackdown on India-linked crime syndicates, the Federal Bureau of Investigation (FBI) issued a federal wanted notice for Harmanveer Singh. He is an Indian national accused of helping the Ravinder Dhanda Organised Crime Group smuggle drugs across the border in Vancouver, Canada.

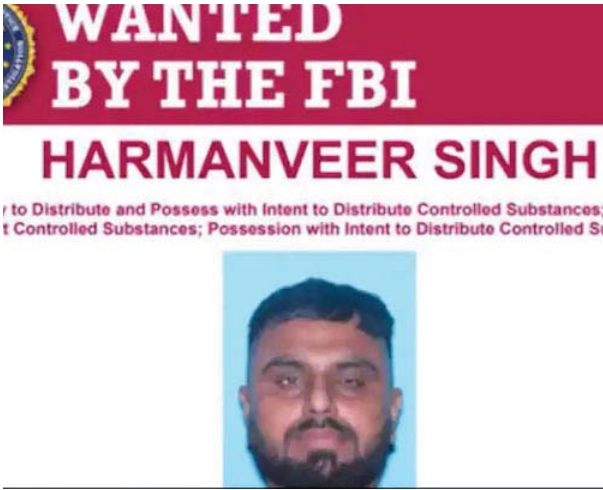
The FBI led Operation Hard Ball for several years, working with the RCMP and other international partners. The investigation resulted in three federal indictments charging 37 people with crimes like racketeering, extortion, violence, firearms offences, and international drug trafficking. Authorities arrested 24 people in the US, Canada, and Europe, but several fugitives, including Singh, remain at large.

Operation Hard Ball was announced in Los Angeles in early July 2026. It targeted three criminal groups based in India that operate in North

America and other regions. One of these is the Bishnoi Organised Crime Group, led by Lawrence Bishnoi, who has been in jail since 2015 and reportedly uses smuggled cellphones.

The Bhagwanpuria gang, led by jailed gangster Jaggu Bhagwanpuria, was involved in murder-for-hire, weapons trafficking, and extortion. The Ravinder Dhanda drug trafficking network mainly operated in British Columbia's Lower Mainland.

Officials described these groups as "brutal transnational organisations that have terrorised families, exploited communities, and stolen lives." US First Assistant Attorney Bill Essayli said, "Transnational criminal gangs who spread fear, drugs, and violence will face the full force of justice... There is no safe harbour for these thugs." and arrest warrants. They seized more than 1,000 kilograms of drugs, mostly cocaine and methamphetamine, along with a kilogram



of heroin. Officers also found dozens of firearms, including a fully automatic machine gun, and tens of thousands of dollars in cash.

The Dhanda organisation is known for allegedly acting as a professional smuggling broker. The indictment says Ravinder Singh Dhanda, also known as "John Wick," ran operations in the Vancouver area, including White Rock and Surrey. He is accused of

organising the storage, transport, smuggling, and distribution of methamphetamine, cocaine, and other drugs across the US-Canada border each week.

The network is accused of hiding hundreds of kilograms of drugs in long-haul semi-trucks carrying real cargo and in farm trucks near the border. It offered "international smuggling services" to drug trafficking groups in

the United States, Canada, and Mexico. From March 2024 to July 2025, the group allegedly stole about 520 kilograms of cocaine from rivals in the Los Angeles area. Dhanda was arrested in British Columbia during the operation and now faces extradition to the United States. The civil forfeiture director in British Columbia is also trying to seize two of his Metro Vancouver properties, worth millions of dollars, claiming they were bought with money from crime.

Harmanveer Singh, born September 26, 1994, is wanted for his alleged role in the Dhanda conspiracy. A federal arrest warrant was issued for him on June 23, 2026, in the US District Court for the Central District of California. He is accused of conspiracy to distribute and possess controlled substances, conspiracy to export controlled substances, and possession with intent to distribute controlled substances. Singh also goes by the names "Hari Gautam" and "Harman

Sandhu." He is described as an Indian male, 5'7" tall, weighing 190 pounds, with black hair and black eyes.

The indictment does not specify Singh's exact role in the group. Still, his inclusion among the accused shows that law enforcement considers him part of the Dhanda network's drug trafficking and export operations. He is still a fugitive, and the FBI is actively seeking information about his whereabouts. The Dhanda case highlights drug smuggling between the US and Canada. The network is said to have moved drugs in commercial vehicles, sometimes with help from corrupt insiders.

Operation Hard Ball is a rare example of cooperation between the US, Canada, India, and Europe against these crime syndicates. As of mid-July 2026, Harmanveer Singh is still on the run. The FBI asks anyone with information to contact their local field office, the nearest US embassy or consulate, or to submit tips online.

West Bengal CM Adhikari flags off 50 eco-friendly AC buses

SAUGAR SENGUPTA
■ Kolkata

Focusing strongly on an eco-friendly transport system, Bengal Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari announced the launching of 1000 eco-friendly air-conditioned buses in phases, flagging off the first 50 on Tuesday.

Saying that in a year's time Bengal would see a discernible change in its transportation system, Adhikari iterated, "We have plans to bring out 1000 buses," besides starting water metro services soon. Disclosing his government's plans to implement an eco-friendly transport system, the Chief Minister said that he had talks with Union Urban Development Minister Manohar Lal Khattar on launching more electric buses in Bengal on a 60:40



West Bengal Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari along with State Chief Secretary Manoj Kumar and others flag off 50 buses at Paribahan Bhawan in Kolkata, West Bengal. PTI

cost partnership between the centre and the state governments. The Chief Minister also unveiled his plans to expand the metro connectivity to lesser cities outside Kolkata. He said that his gov-

ernment was planning to take the metro railway network to the industrial cities of Asansol and Durgapur and Siliguri and Jalpaiguri in North Bengal. "I will request Chief Secretary

(Manoj Agarwal) to prepare projects with the World Bank, the Asian Development Bank or the Housing and Urban Development Corporation (HUDCO)" to start metro connectivity

between Asansol and Durgapur and Siliguri and Jalpaiguri, he said.

Adhikari, who subsequently held a meeting with the State Electricity Department, launched the Vidyut Prahari app to stop theft of electricity. During a review meeting with senior officials, the Chief Minister ordered a zero-tolerance approach so as to stop power pilferage.

"I have asked them not to show any leniency towards the commercial consumers. I know many politicians own such establishments and are not paying power bills ... I will ask you not to take note of any political interference ... don't listen to even BJP leaders ... take a strong stance on power bills ... but show some leniency towards domestic customers who sometimes face hardships," he said.

Private schools in Punjab oppose fee cap ordinance

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Chandigarh

Private school associations in Punjab on Tuesday opposed the State Government's ordinance capping annual fee hikes at five per cent and directing schools to refund fees collected beyond the prescribed limit over the past three years, saying the move could adversely affect the financial viability of schools and the education sector.

Addressing a press conference, National Independent Schools Alliance (NISA) president Kulbhushan Sharma and Recognised Affiliated Schools Association Punjab chairman Harpal Singh (UK) urged the Government to hold consultations with private school associations, parents, educationists and financial experts before implementing the policy.

ED registers PMLA case in ₹336 crore crypto fraud

PRAMOD KUMAR SINGH
■ Bengaluru/New Delhi

The Enforcement Directorate (ED) on Monday registered a money-laundering case under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA) and searched locations linked to an alleged ₹336 crore cryptocurrency fraud targeting a Dutch national.

The Bengaluru office of the agency carried out raids on July 18 and 19, focusing on over-the-counter (OTC) crypto Tokens involved in the case, including MultiverseX, Kava, BEAM, GRASS, SUI, VANA, and AGLD, among others.

The PMLA case began after the cybercrime police station in South Andaman received a complaint from a Dutch national about large-scale cheating in crypto investments.

The ED said the accused took multi-million-dollar investments from the

complainant but stopped delivering the promised tokens when market prices went up.

The ED identified Ravindra K, based in Bengaluru, as the mastermind behind the fraud. The agency now estimates the scam's value at \$35 million (₹336 crore), which is much higher than the \$10 million reported in the original police FIR. During the raids, the ED seized 87,000 USDT. Investigators also found that the same suspects cheated several other foreign investors, many of whom have not yet filed complaints.

OTC crypto trading involves direct, private deals between parties, often outside regulated exchanges. These deals carry greater risk because they lack transparency and oversight, making them attractive to fraudsters who exploit market changes. The ED's action under PMLA lets it



trace, attach, and possibly confiscate the proceeds of crime.

This case highlights the agency's increased focus on cryptocurrency-related money laundering, in which digital assets are used to conceal illicit funds. Ravindra K and his associates allegedly gained the complainant's trust by promising to deliver

tokens but failed to do so when prices rose. As a result, the Dutch investor lost a large sum of money, while the accused retained the funds.

Finding more foreign victims during the Bengaluru searches suggests the scam was bigger than first believed. The ED has asked anyone affected to come forward

and help with the investigation. Crypto fraud has been rising in India in recent years, with more international investors being targeted by complex digital scams.

This case shows how difficult it is for regulators to monitor cross-border OTC deals in anonymous crypto environments. The ED is still investigating to track the full money trail, identify all beneficiaries, and recover assets. More actions, such as attaching property, are expected as the investigation continues, especially for high-risk crypto investments and OTC trades that promise guaranteed delivery or high returns. Doing due diligence on counterparties and using regulated platforms remain important safeguards. The quick registration of the PMLA case and the raids show the ED's determination to act firmly against financial crimes involving new digital assets.

Bengaluru: GBA officials attacked during anti-encroachment drive

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Bengaluru

Street vendors allegedly attacked Bengaluru municipal officers and employees who had gone to clear encroachments on a footpath in Shivaji Nagar on Tuesday.

On the directions of Bengaluru Development Minister Krishna Byre Gowda, officials of the Greater Bengaluru Authority have been carrying out a drive to remove encroachments from pavements.

On Tuesday, when a team of GBA officials reached Shivaji Nagar, some people allegedly turned violent, dragged Assistant Executive Engineer Gowtham and a few other officers onto the road, and assaulted them.

They allegedly used pepper spray on another



official named Ruchitha.

"Five suspected attackers have already been caught by the police. The main instigator, Basavaraj Pudukote, will also be arrested soon. All the attackers will be booked on charges of attempt to murder," a police officer said.

Condemning the attack, Gowda said he had directed the police to take stringent action against those responsible.

"The attackers are not hardworking poor people earning their livelihood.

They are anti-social elements. Assaulting Government officials while they are implementing the Hon'ble Supreme Court's directions is a serious violation of the law. We stand firmly with officers discharging their public duty in accordance with the law," he said.

According to Gowda, the driver of a tractor and the operator of an earthmover engaged in the encroachment removal drive were also hospitalised following the attack.

"Police have arrested some people. I have asked the police to book Basavaraj under the Goonda Act. Those who attacked our staff with pepper spray will be booked on charges of attempted murder," the minister told reporters.

Union Govt sets up cyber teams for Jamtara, Mewat hotspots

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Jamtara in Jharkhand and Mewat in Haryana are among seven regions where the Centre has constituted Joint Cyber Coordination Teams (JCCTs) to strengthen coordination in tackling cybercrime, the Government informed the Lok Sabha on Tuesday.

In a written reply to a question, Minister of State for Home Affairs Bandi Sanjay Kumar said the teams have been set up under the Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre (I4C) for Mewat, Jamtara, Ahmedabad, Hyderabad, Chandigarh, Visakhapatnam and Guwahati.

He said the teams cover the entire country by onboarding States and Union Territories to enhance the coordination framework among law



enforcement agencies in dealing with cybercrime hotspots and cases involving multiple jurisdictions. The minister said the I4C has operationalised the 'Samanvaya' platform as a management information system, data repository and coordination platform for cybercrime data sharing and analytics. Its 'Pratibimb' module maps the locations of criminals and cybercrime infrastructure and facilitates technological assistance to law enforcement agencies.

Omar vows to intensify J&K Statehood stir after Delhi protest

MOHIT KANDHARI
■ Jammu

Even after receiving a cold response from India alliance partners and Kashmir-based Opposition parties, Jammu and Kashmir Chief Minister Omar Abdullah on Tuesday said his party would intensify its agitation until the Centre restores Statehood.

Apparently, the ruling party failed to amplify its demand at the national level in support of restoration of Statehood, as none of the national leaders, including members of the India alliance, attended the sit-in dharna in New Delhi on Monday.

A day after the protest, Omar in Srinagar launched a scathing attack against a section of Opposition parties that stayed away from the protest and mocked the National Conference on their social media handles.

A handful of leaders of the J&K unit of the Congress party

stood with National Conference President Dr Farooq Abdullah as he led the protest march, after the formal permission was denied to stage a sit-in dharna at Jantar Mantar. All other national party leaders and prominent citizens, invited by the National Conference, stayed away.

Addressing a press conference in Srinagar, Omar on Tuesday asserted the Centre must honour its commitment and restore J&K's Statehood.

Defending his party's stand on the issue, Omar said the National Conference had gone to Delhi to remind the Union Government of assurances made in Parliament, before the Supreme Court and to the people of Jammu and Kashmir that Statehood would be restored after the Assembly elections.

"This is the beginning, not the end. The movement will continue," he said, adding that protests would continue in Delhi as well as



across Jammu and Kashmir. Omar said the demand for statehood belonged to all people of Jammu and Kashmir and should not have been reduced to party politics. Without mincing words, Omar clarified that any discussion on constitutional guarantees, including Article 370, can follow only after that.

"What's the meaning of Article 370 without statehood?" Omar asked. "If there's no State, where's the State List? Without statehood, everything remains under the Union List. Statehood is the foundation. Once that foundation is restored, we can move towards discussions on constitutional guarantees," he said.

Responding to criticism that the NC was no longer focusing on Article 370, he said the party had not diluted its stand. "J&K Assembly has already passed a resolution seeking restoration of J&K's special constitutional position, the chief minister said.

Omar said NC president Farooq Abdullah would decide the future course of the agitation. He reiterated there would be "no compromise" until the Centre fulfilled its commitment to restore Statehood.

Without naming any political adversary, Omar said, "I'm not disappointed by the attitude of the Central Government as much as I'm saddened by those who claim to be sympathisers of Jammu and Kashmir but choose to remain silent at crucial moments."

"We invited every political party because this is not the issue of one party or one Government. It concerns the entire people of Jammu and

Kashmir. Instead of joining us, some tried to ridicule and weaken our efforts," he said.

Without naming the People's Democratic Party, Abdullah also criticised parties that had allied with the BJP in the past, saying those questioning the NC's commitment to Article 370 had themselves abandoned their agenda to form a Government with the BJP, while the National Conference had remained consistent on the issue.

On support from other political parties, Abdullah said Congress leaders remained with the NC throughout the protest, while leaders from the CPI and CPI(M) also joined. He added that several opposition leaders, including those from the NCP, Trinamool Congress and the Samajwadi Party, could not reach the venue because of restrictions and road closures in the national Capital.

Aravalli committee seeks public inputs, suggestions

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Supreme Court-constituted Aravalli committee has invited representations, suggestions, and inputs from people on issues related to the Aravalli hill range.

Formed on May 25, the high-powered committee has been tasked with conducting an independent review of the Centre's report on the definition and delineation of the Aravalli hill range.

According to the Environment Ministry's press note on Tuesday, the committee has invited representations, suggestions and inputs from the states of the NCT and various stakeholders, including environmentalists, mining lease holders and local communities, whose livelihoods and wellbeing may be intrinsically linked to the region's biodiversity.

It added that submissions, supported "to the extent possible" by documentary evidence or verifiable mate-



rial, must be submitted via an email or an official Google form within 21 days of the notice. The development has come amid concerns about the committee's neutrality, as it mainly comprises ex-Government officers.

The committee, which has to submit its report by August 31, is headed by Kanchan Devi, Director General of the Indian Council of Forestry Research and Education (ICFRE). Its

members include Subhash Ashutosh, former Director General of the Forest Survey of India, Rajendra Kumar Sharma, former Director of the Geological Survey of India, Brij Mohan Singh Rathore, former Joint Secretary in the Environment Ministry and Professor Ashok K Bhatnagar, former Head of the Department of Botany at Delhi University.

The court also appointed Professor Jagdish

Krishnaswamy of the Indian Institute for Human Settlements, Bengaluru, and Professor Laxmikant Sharma of the Central University of Haryana as special invitees who may be associated with the committee's work by the chairperson as required.

The Environment Ministry was directed to nominate an officer of the rank of Director to serve as the committee's Member Secretary.

Congress to provide legal aid to detained CJP protesters

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Congress on Tuesday offered legal assistance to young persons arrested, detained and attacked during the ongoing protests over the paper leak issue.

The Opposition party put out a Google Form link so its team could reach out to those in need of such legal aid. Congress general secretary in-charge communications Jairam Ramesh said the AICC has instructed its legal team to provide them all possible assistance.

Ramesh also shared details of contacts and urged those in need of legal aid in connection with the protests to fill the Google Form Link so that the Congress team can reach out to them.



Delhi Police has registered four FIRs so far and is in the process of filing two more in connection with violence, vandalism and other incidents during the march to Parliament organised by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) on July 20.

The cases were registered at Parliament Street, Connaught Place and other police stations, and invoke multiple provisions of the

Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS), the Arms Act and the Prevention of Damage to Public Property Act, sources said. Security arrangements have been stepped up across the national Capital following Monday's clashes, in which Delhi Police said more than 118 police personnel and around 60 protesters were injured, and over 20 police vehicles were damaged.

Karnataka BJP to launch mega outreach on SIR

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Shivamogga

Karnataka BJP President BY Vijayendra on Tuesday said the party will hold a "mega outreach campaign" on July 25 and 26 regarding the SIR of electoral rolls underway in the State. The campaign aims to reach one crore households across Karnataka, he added.

He said the campaign will be held in every Assembly constituency under the lead-



Karnataka BJP President
BY Vijayendra

ership of the BJP leaders and workers. All BJP MPs, MLAs, MLCs, former elected representatives and party workers will participate.

"We plan to reach about one crore households. Party workers will visit homes to create awareness about the enumeration form, address voters' concerns and confusion, and encourage support for the successful completion of the Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls," he told reporters here, adding that each party worker had been assigned a minimum of 20 households.

Noting that Karnataka is facing a severe drought due to inadequate rainfall, the BJP chief criticised Chief Minister DK Shivakumar and the State Government for holding meetings through video conference from Bengaluru instead of visiting the affected areas.

46 KCP cadres lay down arms before Manipur CM

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ Imphal

In a major security breakthrough that promises to usher in a stable and development-oriented era in Manipur, 46 active cadres of the proscribed Kangleipak Communist Party (People's War Group) surrendered before Chief Minister Y Khemchand Singh at the Mantripukhri Garrison in Imphal East district on Tuesday.

The event, organised as a 'Home Coming Ceremony' at the Headquarters of Assam Rifles (South), was attended by senior Government functionaries and top security officers. These included the State Home Minister, the Minister of Art & Culture and Tourism, local MLAs, the Chief Secretary, the Security Advisor to the Manipur Government, the General Officer Commanding Spear Corps, the Manipur DGP, the IG Assam Rifles (South), and the DIG CRPF.

Choosing to shun the path of violence and return to mainstream civilian life, the cadres laid down 28 sophisticated weapons. The surrendered arsenal included AK series rifles, .303 rifles, pistols, single and double-barrel rifles, an INSAS rifle, a Self Loading Rifle (SLR), Carbine Machine Guns, and a Rocket Propelled Grenade (RPG) launcher, along with a substantial quantity of ammunition, magazines, and explosives.

Security officials highlighted the significance of the event, pointing out that none of the 46 surrendering cadres was bound by prior peace agreements. Founded on 14 April 1980 by communist



The event organised as a Home Coming Ceremony at the headquarters of Assam Rifles (South) was attended by CM Y Khemchand, senior Government functionaries and top security officers PIONEER PHOTO

ideologues Y Ibohambi and Ibohishak, the KCP subsequently broke into various splinter factions. The People's War Group (PWG) faction emerged as a highly disruptive unit, severely impacting normal life across the valley districts, including Imphal East, Imphal West, and Kakching.

While surrenders from the KCP (PWG) were historically limited to small increments of five to twelve cadres, the simultaneous surrender of 46 active militants is unprecedented for this specific outfit. Officials noted that while the mass surrender may not

signal the complete dissolution of the faction, it inflicts a severe operational setback on its regional extortion networks and reach.

Security agencies attributed the successful turnaround to weeks of sustained, civilian-first outreach conducted by the Assam Rifles, Manipur Police, and State administrative machinery. Officials expressed optimism that the move would pave the way for long-stalled infrastructure projects and regional economic development in the State.

Himanta inaugurates first MBA batch of IIM Guwahati

TONY DAS ■ Guwahati

Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma on Tuesday inaugurated the first Master of Business Administration (MBA) batch (2026-28) of the Indian Institute of Management (IIM) Guwahati at its transit campus at Tech City, Bongora in Kamrup district.

The inaugural batch comprises 52 students drawn from 18 States across the country. IIM Guwahati has commenced its academic journey under the mentorship of IIM Ahmedabad and will eventually shift to a permanent campus spread over 574 bighas in Palashbari Revenue Circle, expected to be completed within three years.

Speaking on the occasion, the Chief Minister called it a landmark achievement in Assam's educational journey. He expressed gratitude to Prime Minister Narendra



Modi and Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan for their support, noting that under the Prime Minister's leadership, the number of IIMs in India has expanded from 13 in 2014 to 22 at present.

The State Government developed the transit campus

at an investment of nearly ₹39 crore, equipping it with modern lecture halls, administrative blocks, faculty residences, and three hostel blocks. Following the inauguration of the academic session by Prime Minister Narendra Modi on February 14, 2026, the institute initiated

ed its Executive Education programmes before launching its flagship MBA programme within five months.

Sarma remarked that alongside IIT Guwahati, AIIMS Guwahati, IIIT, NIPER, and the upcoming National Forensic Sciences University, IIM Guwahati further

strengthens Assam's position as an emerging hub of premier national institutions.

Minister of Education Ranaj Pegu, MLA Himangshu Sekhar Baishya, Director of IIM Ahmedabad Professor Bharat Bhasker, Commissioner and Secretary, Higher Education Department Narayan Konwar, senior Government officials, faculty members, students and a host of other dignitaries were present on the occasion.

Earlier in the day, the Chief Minister also inaugurated the ₹53.84-crore Digital Design and 3D Printing Centre of Excellence at Tech City, established under the PM-DeVINE scheme. Additionally, he performed the Bhumi Pujan and laid the foundation stone for the new integrated Co-District Commissioner's Office complex at Palashbari, being built at an estimated cost of ₹20 crore.

Unacceptable: India protests killing of 4 sailors by Russia

ASHOKE RAJ ■ New Delhi

India has summoned Russia's top diplomat in the capital to register a strong protest after four Indian seafarers were killed in a Russian attack on a civilian merchant vessel off the Ukrainian coast, marking the first reported deaths of Indian crew members in the ongoing Russia-Ukraine conflict.

The Foreign Ministry on Monday called in Russian Charge d'Affaires Vladimir Ladanov following the attack on the Guinea-Bissau-flagged vessel MV Golden Leo, which was navigating Ukraine's maritime corridor on Sunday evening while departing from the port of Odesa.

In a strongly worded statement, the Ministry conveyed India's "grave concerns and unequivocal condemnation" of the strike, which resulted in the tragic loss of four Indian lives. It emphasised that such attacks "undermine the safety, security, and stability of international maritime commerce."

"The Russian Charge d'Affaires was requested to convey India's strong concerns to his authorities that the tar-



Vladimir Ladanov

geting of commercial shipping and the resulting loss of innocent civilian lives are unacceptable and must be avoided," the Ministry said.

The vessel had 17 crew members, including five Indian nationals, at the time of the attack. According to information available to Indian authorities, four Indians lost their lives while the fifth is hospitalised in critical condition.

Ukrainian Foreign Minister Andrii Sybiba stated that a total of 10 seafarers were killed in the incident — four Indians and six Syrians.

India has condemned the attack without directly naming Russia in its public statement, reiterating that "targeting commercial shipping and endangering innocent civilian crew members, or otherwise impeding freedom of navigation and commerce, is deplorable and should be avoided."

The Indian Mission in Ukraine is closely monitoring the situation and is extending all possible assistance to the affected crew members and their families. The Ministry extended deepest condolences to the families of the deceased and wished the injured seafarer a speedy and full recovery.

This incident has triggered fresh calls from New Delhi for the protection of commercial shipping during armed conflicts and has highlighted the risks faced by thousands of Indian seafarers operating in the Black Sea region. The Ministry described the loss as "tragic" and stressed that civilian vessels and their crews must not become targets in the conflict.

AIAWU observes first death anniversary of former Kerala CM VS Achuthanandan

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ New Delhi

The All India Agricultural Workers' Union (AIAWU) observed the first death anniversary of veteran communist leader, former Kerala Chief Minister, and its founding member VS Achuthanandan at its central office at HKS Surjeet Bhawan in New Delhi on Tuesday.

Representatives and activists from several left-wing mass organisations, including the All India Kisan Sabha (AIKS), Centre of Indian Trade Unions (CITU), Students' Federation of India (SFI), and Democratic Youth Federation of India (DYFI), gathered to pay floral tributes and recall his decades-long legacy of peasant and working-class struggles.

Addressing the gathering, leaders recalled the pivotal role played by Achuthanandan in spearheading agricultural workers' movements across Kerala, particularly his mili-



VS Achuthanandan

tant struggle for land rights, housing, and the protection of agrarian livelihoods.

Speakers highlighted his historic contribution following the enactment of the Land Reforms Act under the EMS Namboodiripad administration. Achuthanandan, alongside legendary communist icon AK Gopalan,

led the nationwide movement for its immediate enforcement, including presiding over the historic January 1970 Alappuzha convention of farmers and agricultural labourers. His campaign to prevent the illegal conversion of paddy fields for non-agricultural purposes was also highlighted as a cornerstone of his agrarian legacy.

Prominent leaders attending the solemn event included B. Venkat, Vikram Singh, T Babumohanam, and Sahil from AIAWU; Vijoo Krishnan and P Krishnaprasad from AIKS; M Saibabu and KN Umesh from CITU; Sanjeev Kumar from DYFI; and Abdul Wahab and Gopika K Babu from SFI.

Extending their heartfelt condolences to the family members and comrades of the late Marxist stalwart, the participating unions pledged to carry forward his legacy and continue the struggle for social justice and land rights.

MP secures ₹6,200 crore Paras Defence semiconductor project

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Bhopal

Madhya Pradesh has secured a major investment in the semiconductor sector, with Paras Defence and Space Technologies Ltd proposing to invest ₹6,200 crore to establish an Outsourced Semiconductor Assembly and Test (OSAT) facility in the state. The project is expected to generate more than 2,500 direct employment opportunities.

The investment proposal was formalised on Tuesday with the signing of a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) between the Madhya Pradesh Government's Department of Science and Technology and Paras Defence and Space Technologies Pvt Ltd. The agreement was exchanged in the presence of Chief Minister Mohan Yadav at the Chief Minister's office in the State Assembly.

Welcoming the investment, Yadav urged investors to invest confidently in Madhya Pradesh, assuring them of the government's



full support in facilitating industrial projects. He also felicitated the company's representatives during the meeting.

The company's Managing Director, Manjul Sharad Shah, informed the Chief Minister that the proposed semiconductor project would be developed in phases, with an initial investment of Rs 6,200 crore. He said the company has already identified suitable land and will soon submit a formal proposal for its allotment. Officials said the project is expected to provide a significant boost to Madhya Pradesh's semicon-

ductor and high-technology manufacturing ecosystem while accelerating industrial growth, investment and employment generation.

Principal Secretary, Industrial Policy and Investment Promotion, Raghendra Kumar Singh, said the company was encouraged by the state's semiconductor policy, which played a key role in its investment decision.

Managing Director of Madhya Pradesh Industrial Development Corporation (MPIDC), Chandramauli Shukla, said Paras Defence is one of India's leading defence and space technology companies with more than four decades of experience in precision engineering and indigenous technology development.

The company develops advanced systems for the defence, aerospace and space sectors, including optics and optronics, defence electronics, electro-optical and infrared systems, anti-drone technologies, RF and microwave systems, quantum technologies and heavy engineering solutions.

M.P. MADHYA KSHETRA VIDYUT VITARAN CO. LTD.
OFFICE OF THE GENERAL MANAGER (CITY) CIRCLE, GWALIOR
ROSHNIGAR, INDERGANJ, GWALIOR-474009
TEL : 0751-2448207, 0751-2448276, E-mail : secitygwalior1@gmail.com
NO.GM/CC/GWL/PUR/NIT/25-26/3797
Gwalior Dated : 20.07.2026

TENDER NOTICE

MPMKVVCL, Gwalior invites bids for following item through e-tendering

Particulars	Approx. Value (In. Lakh)	Tender Fee (inclusive of GST @18%) (In Rs.)	Opening Date of Tender online
Empanelment of Agencies for Restoration of Distribution Infrastructure during Emergency in City Circle Gwalior	100.00 Lakhs	5900/-	11.08.2026 at 15:00 Hrs.

Other details, terms and conditions are available on company website: <https://portal.mpcz.in> & <https://mptenders.gov.in> or the under signed office.
M.P. Madhyam/127082/2026

GM (CITY)



Editor's
TAKE

Monsoon of discontent

Four weeks, 28 pending Bills, and a House that adjourned within hours of convening: the Monsoon Session has begun with a storm

Parliament's Monsoon Session, running from July 20 to August 13 with nineteen sittings, carries a packed legislative docket: Bills on income tax, MSME reform, foreign contributions, births-and-deaths registration, and a new higher-education regulator to replace the UGC and AICTE. But one Bill will dominate everything else - the Constitution (130th Amendment) Bill, which proposes automatically removing a Prime Minister, Chief Minister or minister from office after thirty days in judicial custody on serious charges. The Joint Parliamentary Committee reviewing it has voted to retain this clause even as formal adoption of its full report remains stalled, with safeguards against misuse still under negotiation. Government MPs frame this as plain accountability; Opposition parties – several of whose leaders have faced arrest in recent years – call it a constitutional weapon dressed up as reform, warning that it tramples the presumption of innocence and unsettles the federal balance.

Expect this to be the session's defining constitutional argument. Politically, though, the Opposition's energy is aimed elsewhere. A privilege motion against Defence Minister Rajnath Singh – accused of telling the House that no soldiers died in Operation Sindoor, only for six names to later appear on the National War Memorial – has reopened a wound from last year's military campaign. Equally combustible is the NEET-UG paper leak, a scandal serious enough to force the cancellation of this year's medical entrance examination and trigger CBI arrests; activist Sonam Wangchuk's hunger strike, tying exam reform to Ladakh's long-pending statehood demand, and police action against students marching on Parliament have already produced chaotic scenes on the floor.

A third flashpoint – allegations of theft from Ram Temple donation collections in Ayodhya – adds a religious dimension that the Opposition hopes will travel beyond party lines. Underneath these headline rows runs a steadier current: the Election Commission's Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls, now expanding nationwide, with enumeration deadlines falling squarely within the session in states such as West Bengal, Tamil Nadu and Kerala that vote later this year. The Opposition calls it disenfranchisement by paperwork; the government insists it is a neutral, constitutionally sanctioned clean-up. Add rising prices and continuing unease over the India-US tariff deal, which critics say was struck at the expense of Indian agriculture, and the ingredients for a turbulent four weeks are complete.

What is less certain is whether any of this gets debated rather than merely shouted about. Day one ended, as these sessions often do, in adjournment before Question Hour properly began. Parliament has serious arguments to have this Monsoon – about liberty and accountability, about examination integrity, about who gets to vote. Whether the well of the House proves more useful than the aisles around it remains, as ever, the real test.

A state caught in the regional crossfire

While Jordan and Iran have never been outright enemies, competing strategic interests, shifting alliances and Iran's expanding influence have turned a once-cordial relationship into one marked by mistrust and geopolitical friction



BHOPINDER SINGH

Iran's Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps (IRGC) attack on an American military base in Jordan, which killed at least two US soldiers, triggered another cycle of retaliation between Washington and Tehran. Iranian military sites were subsequently targeted, while Jordanian forces reported intercepting additional Iranian missiles and drones. The episode suggested that Jordan, despite efforts to remain insulated from regional conflicts, was being drawn deeper into the widening confrontation between Iran and the United States.

This was not the first time Jordan found itself caught in the crossfire. In April 2024, during Iran's first direct large-scale attack on Israel, the Jordanian Air Force intercepted and destroyed Iranian drones and missiles passing through its airspace towards Israel. Tehran viewed the action as assistance to Israel, reinforcing its suspicion of Amman's strategic alignment.

Yet Iran's historical hostility towards Jordan has been primarily strategic rather than ideological or sectarian. Jordan is targeted less because of its domestic character and more because of its geography, alliances and role in the regional security architecture. Positioned between Iran's sphere of influence and Israel, closely aligned with the United States, and central to Western security arrangements, Jordan occupies a sensitive position in the Middle Eastern balance of power.

This alignment is notable given Jordan's demographic complexity. An estimated 50-60 per cent of Jordan's population is of Palestinian origin, including prominent figures such as Queen Rania, wife of King Abdullah II, whose family roots are Palestinian. Despite this demographic reality and widespread public sympathy for the Palestinian cause, the Jordanian state has continued to prioritise strategic ties with Washington and maintain a cautious security relationship with Israel.

The relationship between Jordan and Iran has evolved through decades of shifting alliances, ideological competition and competing visions for the Middle East. Although the two countries have maintained diplomatic relations and experienced periods of limited engagement, their ties have largely been defined by mistrust, particularly since the Iranian Revolution of 1979.

Before the revolution, relations were considerably warmer. Both Jordan and Iran were monarchies, ie, the Hashemite Kingdom of Jordan and the Pahlavi monarchy of Iran. Both



THE IRAN-IRAQ WAR OF 1980-1988 MARKED A FURTHER DETERIORATION IN RELATIONS. JORDAN SUPPORTED SADDAM HUSSEIN'S IRAQ, PROVIDING ECONOMIC AND POLITICAL ASSISTANCE DURING ITS WAR WITH IRAN. FOR TEHRAN, JORDAN'S BACKING OF BAGHDAD REPRESENTED ALIGNMENT WITH AN OPPOSING REGIONAL CAMP AND REINFORCED ITS DISTRUST OF AMMAN

The writer, a military veteran, is a former Lt Governor of Andaman & Nicobar Islands and Pudukcherry

maintained close partnerships with Western powers (and even with Israel) during the Cold War. They shared concerns about revolutionary movements and regional instability, including the influence of Arab nationalist movements inspired by Gamal Abdel Nasser.

The Iranian Revolution fundamentally altered these equations. The establishment of the Islamic Republic transformed Iran from a traditional monarchy into an ideological state challenging Western influence and seeking greater regional sway. Tehran's support for regional militant movements and opposition to US-aligned governments unsettled Arab monarchies, including Jordan. Amman, dependent on Western security partnerships and moderate Arab alliances, became increasingly wary of Iran's ambitions.

The Iran-Iraq War of 1980-1988 marked a further deterioration in relations. Jordan supported Saddam Hussein's Iraq, providing economic and political assistance during its war with Iran. For Tehran, Jordan's backing of Baghdad represented alignment with an opposing regional camp and reinforced its distrust of Amman.

Relations remained restrained in subsequent decades, but tensions intensified after the 2003 US invasion of Iraq. The removal of Saddam Hussein allowed Iran to expand its influence among Iraq's Shia political parties and armed groups. Jordan feared that Iranian influence was extending through Iraq into Syria and Lebanon, creating a continuous arc of political and military influence across the region. In 2004, King Abdullah II warned of a

cross-border trafficking networks. These concerns strengthened Jordan's reliance on security cooperation with Western and Arab partners.

Despite these tensions, Jordan and Iran have avoided a complete diplomatic rupture. Both understand the risks of direct confrontation and have maintained channels of communication. Jordan's principal concerns today revolve around Iranian-backed armed groups, cross-border insecurity and the wider competition between Iran and US-aligned states for influence in the Middle East.

For Iran, Jordan represents a state closely integrated into the American-led regional security system and linked to Israel through a peace treaty. For Jordan, Iran is not an existential military threat in the conventional sense, but its expanding regional influence represents a challenge to Jordan's security calculations.

The history of Jordan-Iran relations, therefore, reflects a wider pattern in Middle Eastern politics: cooperation when interests converge, but rivalry when competing visions of regional order collide.

From the relatively cordial relationship of the pre-1979 era to today's strategic tensions, the dispute has been shaped less by direct hostility between the two peoples and more by the broader contest for influence, security and political dominance that has defined the modern Middle East. In this context, Jordan's involvement in the current Iran-US confrontation is not an unexpected development, but the latest chapter in a long-running geopolitical struggle.

PIC TALK



Shikaras carrying tourists ply on Dal Lake as heavy monsoon clouds gather over the surrounding hills in Srinagar, Jammu and Kashmir. PHOTO: PTI



SITENDER SEHRAWAT

2ND OPINION

Mankind seeks what lies at its core, but mostly looks elsewhere – in things, material goods and trends. But there's a shift happening now. View it from the surface and it makes no sense. Look deeper and it does. The shift is in how we seek connection, peace and meaning. The spiritual seeking, the longing to meet yourself, your creator and something beyond, is not confined to spiritual centres. People are losing trust in the endless cycle of quick fixes, wellness gadgets and self-optimisation frameworks. They're asking fundamentally different questions about what they actually crave, not what the market tells them they should want. For many, the search is led by genuine longing from within. But it will shift; what is natural and authentic eventually endures.

For decades, the self-help, personal development and

wellness industry promised that better outcomes were just three steps, four weeks or one purchase away.

Meditation apps that fit into lunch breaks. Productivity systems that promised to unlock peace and clarity. Weekend transformation programmes that promised enlightenment in condensed form. The promise was always the same: optimise yourself relentlessly and you'll feel better. Solve yourself through discipline and framework, and happiness will follow as a reward. Of course, it didn't work. Or rather, it worked just enough to feel like your fault when it failed.

The recurring subscriptions and retreat visits were the subtle ask beneath it all. The goalpost always moved. Better sleep didn't solve loneliness. More productivity didn't generate actual meaning. Workplace loneliness became the leading cause of people leaving their jobs because belonging is inherently embedded in us. People pushed forward, hoping the next thing would work; then came AI, restoring false hope and pushing them further into the cycle. Optimisation left people sharper but profoundly emptier, more efficient at being hollow.

What's emerging now is structurally different. People aren't abandoning the search for depth; they're abandoning the illusion that depth arrives through applications and 30-day challenges. They're discovering that real transformation requires time, years sometimes. It comes from deep layers of being, not through spiritual programmes promising mystical self-upgrades that

inevitably spiral back down. Real change happens in silence, not through constant content consumption. Real stillness cannot be rushed, manufactured or optimised. It is experienced directly, from your own search within.

This is why people who have tried everything are now seeking actual timeless traditions – practices that have survived across centuries, not repackaged versions marketed for quick results. Why they're spending time in silence without measuring progress. Why they're drawn to spaces where nothing is being sold, nothing optimised, nothing measured for engagement. The entire economy of attention is exhausting itself. In India and globally, a growing category has learned to distrust "Enlightenment in 7 days" promises. They can smell the difference between genuine teaching and selling. Between authentic transmission and therapeutic rebranding. They know when they're being offered actual depth versus another consumable designed for the market. A cultural literacy is returning.

What they're seeking is not faster results, but spaces where depth unfolds at its own pace. The return isn't to spirituality as a concept; it's to slowness as a fundamental mode of being. Across India and globally, people are quietly stepping away from the optimisation treadmill, not to find a better version of themselves, but to return to themselves.

The writer is a spiritual seeker and founder of Antaha

UK: BURNHAM PROMISES A NEW SOCIAL AND POLITICAL ORDER

Over the past ten years, British voters have witnessed the emergence of seven Prime Ministers, highlighting an era of political instability and shifting public expectations. Against this backdrop, Andy Burnham's promise of a new social and political model has generated hope for a fresh approach to governance. Such expectations, however, will be fulfilled only if backed by practical reforms and measurable outcomes. Strengthening public healthcare, improving educational standards, expanding affordable housing, creating quality employment opportunities and reducing regional inequalities should remain central priorities. Equally noteworthy was the dignified manner in which outgoing Prime Minister Keir Starmer accepted the electoral verdict. His graceful transition reflected political

maturity and respect for democratic values. In many countries, leadership changes are often accompanied by bitterness, personal attacks and prolonged political confrontation that erode public trust in institutions. A peaceful transfer of power demonstrates that democratic competition need not descend into personal hostility.

Strong democracies are sustained not only by free and fair elections but also by the willingness of winners and losers to uphold constitutional norms. Ultimately, lasting public confidence depends less on campaign promises and more on transparent, accountable governance that delivers tangible improvements in citizens' everyday lives.

A MYLSAMI | COIMBATORE

Please send your letter to the info@dailypioneer.com. In more than 250 words. We appreciate your feedback.

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

It is time to empower women

The delay in officially acknowledging the sacrifice of six soldiers during Operation Sindoor has raised serious concerns. While governments may withhold operational details for strategic reasons, there can be no justification for delaying recognition of those who laid down their lives in the service of the nation.

A grateful nation must never allow its martyrs to fade into anonymity. Behind every soldier's sacrifice stands a grieving family that bears an irreparable loss with dignity and pride. No parent, spouse or child can ever forget a loved one who made the ultimate sacrifice. These families, along with the soldiers' regiments and fellow servicemen, deserve the nation's enduring respect and gratitude. It would therefore be a fitting tribute if the names of these six brave soldiers were also inscribed at the Baisaran Martyrs Memorial in Pahalgam alongside the 26 civilians who lost their lives in the tragic terrorist attack.

Such a gesture would honour all those who paid the highest price in the same tragic chain of events and reinforce the nation's commitment to remembering every sacrifice equally. National gratitude should never distinguish between civilian victims and soldiers who gave their lives protecting the country.

JAYANTHY S MANIAM | MUMBAI

Time to address students' concerns

The government is now in an unprecedentedly difficult situation. Its own acts of commission and omission have conspired against it and put it on the defensive.

Ironically, the BJP-led NDA government is gaining numerical strength in Parliament while public support for it is fraying at the edges.

Public perception of the government has changed since the botched entrance exams and the revelation of theft of donations at the Ram temple in Ayodhya. The fact that most student protesters hail from the traditional support base of the BJP is of immense political significance. Its failure to address issues affecting the country's young people and their future has put the government under pressure.

News coverage by certain media outlets favours the government over the protesting students and gives a distorted picture of events. 'Blaming the victim' cannot absolve the government of culpability for the crack-down. Injured protesters undergoing treatment are proof of police brutality.

Nevertheless, we appeal to the Prime Minister to make a complete overhaul of the educational system a top priority so that young people can have a bright future.

G DAVID MILTON | MARUTHANCODE

Vikram-1 opens new space frontier

Skyroot Aerospace's Vikram-1 made India the third country after the US and China to have successfully flown a privately developed orbital launch vehicle. Reaching orbit on a maiden flight is far from guaranteed, but Skyroot did it. Less than eight years old, Skyroot competes in the small-satellite launch space with companies that have far more experience.

Skyroot expects only a third of its demand to be domestic and the remaining two-thirds to come from the US, Japan, Europe and Southeast Asia. For international customers to choose Skyroot, price and schedule reliability will be crucial. Vikram-1 has taken the first step in the right direction, but to give customers confidence, Skyroot must prove that the vehicle is reliable and repeatable.

Skyroot should also look beyond launching rockets towards satellites, in-space services and government anchor contracts to make it a viable proposition. Its success could also strengthen India's position in the rapidly growing global commercial space market. India needs both ISRO and private players like Skyroot to coexist, much like NASA and SpaceX. Private players will continue to bank upon ISRO's massive expertise to fulfil their ambitions.

BAL GOVIND | NOIDA

The CJP protest: Democracy, dissent and the rule of law

The NEET-related protests at Jantar Mantar and the proposed march to Parliament underscore the delicate balance between the constitutional right to peaceful protest and the State's duty to maintain public order. The challenge is to ensure that neither democratic freedoms nor public institutions become casualties of confrontation



A CONFIDENT
DEMOCRACY
IS NOT
MEASURED
BY THE
ABSENCE OF
PROTESTS.
IT IS MEASURED
BY ITS ABILITY
TO
ACCOMMODATE
DISSENT
WHILE
PRESERVING
PUBLIC
ORDER



GURINDER
SINGH DHILLON

How should a democratic State balance the fundamental right to protest with its equally important obligation to maintain public order?

The concerns raised by students regarding the NEET examination deserve serious attention. Educational examinations shape the future of millions of young Indians, and any perception of unfairness naturally creates anxiety and distrust. Instead of viewing such concerns as merely a law-and-order issue, the Government should consider constituting a Parliamentary Committee to examine the shortcomings and recommend institutional reforms that inspire greater public confidence.

Peaceful protest is not merely permitted under the Constitution; it is one of democracy's greatest strengths. Citizens must have adequate space to express disagreement with government policies and administrative decisions. However, every democratic right carries a corresponding constitutional responsibility. A protest march towards Parliament is entirely legitimate, provided it does not obstruct the functioning of Parliament or seek to diminish the dignity of one of the Republic's highest constitutional institutions.

During my years in policing, I learned that most peaceful protests do not fail because of the protesters or the police; they fail when communication between the two breaks down. The objective of democratic policing is not merely to enforce the law but to facilitate the lawful exercise of constitutional rights while preserving public order.

The available visuals suggest that while the Delhi Police handled a challenging situation, there remains room for improvement in operational planning. It is not publicly clear whether a structured negotiation regarding routes, timings and restrictions had been concluded with the protest leadership before the march commenced. Such advance coordination often prevents unnecessary confrontation and builds confidence between citizens and law-enforcement agencies. The detention of Sonam Wangchuk for medical intervention has also generated public debate. Similar preventive interventions have been recognised by constitutional courts under appropriate circumstances. In this instance, the Delhi High Court's directions are available on record. Comparable police interventions have occurred in several States whenever immediate medical or humanitarian concerns arose.

At the same time, protest leadership carries responsibilities that extend beyond mobilising public opinion. Organisers must ensure that participants remain peaceful and that no individual or group

A constitutional perspective on the right to protest, public order and institutional responsibility.

The developments at Jantar Mantar and the proposed march towards the Parliament of India once again bring into focus a constitutional question that every mature democracy must repeatedly answer:

INDIA'S GENERATION
Z DESERVES
APPRECIATION. THEY
ARE AMONG THE
COUNTRY'S MOST
EDUCATED AND
AWARE
GENERATIONS.
THEIR ENERGY,
INNOVATION AND
CONSTITUTIONAL
AWARENESS CAN
BECOME A
TREMENDOUS
DEMOCRATIC
STRENGTH WHEN
CHANNELLED
PEACEFULLY AND
RESPONSIBLY

Gurinder Singh Dhillon, IPS (Retd.)
served as Additional Director General
of Police

crosses constitutional or legal boundaries, resulting in violence or disruption of public order.

Delhi, as home to nearly twenty-three million residents and the seat of India's constitutional institutions, requires careful balancing between democratic freedoms and civic stability. The visual evidence from the protest also suggests that police deployment, manpower and equipment could have been organised more professionally. Modern crowd management depends not merely upon numbers but upon planning, communication, intelligence gathering and calibrated responses. Visible preparedness itself often reduces the possibility of confrontation.

Now that dialogue between the protest representatives and the Union Government has commenced, responsibility equally shifts to the leadership of the movement. Genuine democratic protests can quickly lose legitimacy if mischievous elements, political opportunists or those seeking confrontation succeed in hijacking the movement. Maintaining discipline is, therefore, as important as articulating demands.

India's Constitution protects the right of every citizen - irrespective of age, gender or social background - to protest peacefully. However, democratic movements cannot substitute constitutional processes nor seek to undermine other organs established by the Constitution. Rights and responsibilities must always travel together.

Senior officers of the Delhi Police should personally supervise such situations and maintain the highest standards of operational preparedness. Professional policing not only protects public order but also strengthens India's international image as a confident constitutional democracy capable of accommodating dissent without disorder.

Political leaders, irrespective of party affiliation, have every democratic right to participate in public movements. Yet leadership also demands restraint. Whenever any participant attempts to cross legal limits, responsible political leadership must intervene promptly to prevent escalation.

The Government, on its part, should respond to genuine public grievances without unnecessary delay. Administrative bottlenecks and institutional shortcomings should never be allowed to accumulate to the point where young citizens lose confidence in public institutions. Equally, the Ministry of Home Affairs and the Delhi Police should continue refining a long-term strategy that facilitates peaceful democratic protests while ensuring public order with the minimum necessary use of force. Democratic policing succeeds through communication and preparation far more than through coercion.

India's Generation Z deserves appreciation. They are among the country's most educated and aware generations. Their energy, innovation and constitutional awareness can become a tremendous democratic strength when channelled peacefully and responsibly.

Finally, accountability must exist at every level. Government departments responsible for educational administration should ensure that legitimate concerns are addressed within a reasonable timeframe. The Union Education Minister must continue responding to these issues with maturity, fairness and transparency, ensuring that every decision is guided by merit, facts and the rule of law.

A confident democracy is not measured by the absence of protests. It is measured by its ability to accommodate dissent while preserving public order, respecting constitutional institutions and ensuring that both the Government and its citizens remain equally accountable to the Constitution.

Feminism is out, realism is in



AMITABH
SRIVASTAVA

The great Indian feminism circus has run its full circle, or so it appears.

It was a strange scenario. At a recent seminar held to highlight the problems faced by women in performing their duties in the police and paramilitary forces, while the senior officers on the dais appeared genuinely concerned, if not condescending, towards their problems, almost every single woman from the Police, BSF and Forensic Science Department among the audience was saying, "Thanks, but no thanks."

This was not a sarcastic response but was said with full sincerity and a sort of apprehension among these women about the fallout of all the concessions and talk of reservations for women.

It takes me back to a similar programme I had attended about five years ago, where the theme was almost the same — why is the percentage of women joining the police force not going beyond 12-13 per cent despite a target of 33 per cent set by successive Governments?

The seminar, organised by the Indian Police Foundation this Tuesday at the India International Centre on "Presence of Women Workforce in Police Organisations at Subordinate Ranks in India", had eminent IAS officers like GK Pillai, former Home Secretary; Amod K Kanth, former DG and Founder and Mentor of NGO Prayas; SP Singh, Treasurer of the India Police Foundation; and Nuzhat Hassan, former DG Home Guards, among others.

While in the earlier programme, women police officers at the highest level were highlighting their problems, especially the lack of women's toilets and changing rooms and punishing working hours, this time, in the year 2026, the women flinched every time the speakers on the dais spoke about the new concessions to provide a level playing field to women generally and, more specifically, those in police organisations. Setting the tone, Pillai mentioned the example of Kiran Bedi, his batchmate in 1972, who was offered direct entry into the IAS by the UPSC Board but refused to take any favours.

She said she would join the IPS and take issues such as the lack of women's toilets in her stride, thus becoming the first woman IPS officer in the country.



But he was happy that today most such issues, like women's toilets, changing rooms and crèches, which were considered a favour earlier, were now mandatory and compulsory.

He also disclosed that when it was discovered that victims who complained about their bosses or colleagues under POSH were resigning after some time, even when they were proved right, in corporates, the police and even the judiciary, a new order stated that if a victim resigned, the head of HR would also have to resign for not making the atmosphere congenial for her.

Amod K Kanth, with 38 years of experience with Prayas and allied organisations, asserted matter-of-factly that whether women in the police were 13 per cent or 33 per cent, for the social sector, it was the women police personnel who were the mainstream because it was they who handled issues concerning children and women in every part of the country.

But as the women representatives were handed the mike to talk about their challenges and their tales of fighting adversity and patriarchy for more than an hour, especially adjusting their married lives with their night duties, the common refrain was that the more laws favouring women were brought in, the more they felt scared of their boomeranging on them.

For instance, when Pillai disclosed that HR heads would be forced to resign if victims who complained under POSH resigned, there was no wild cheering.

Then, a woman sitting beside me broke the silence and pointed out guardedly that because of such rules, corporates had stopped recruiting women, while many nodded in agreement.

We are also aware of court observations when some women raised the issue of three days' menstrual leave. A senior supervisor mentioned that when she asked women to join duty with men on the night shift, one of them started crying incessantly that this would destroy her marriage. Finally, she relented, but night shifts were a problem for married women because husbands had this fear that their wives were having an affair.

But the tenor of the speakers was as if they were feeling guilty about complaining, even as they said they had to put in 150 per cent if the men gave their 100 per cent to prove worthy of their salary.

The most interesting fallout of this programme was that while some women felt that even six months of maternity leave was not sufficient for childbirth, some said that the leave facility should also be extended to men, as they had an equal responsibility in bringing up a family.

Either because of the high praise for Kiran Bedi for breaking the glass ceiling in 1972 or through stories of women's empowerment that are showcased in cinema and on OTT platforms, almost every woman who spoke up at this programme said that after all the concessions to women, it was time to think of men as equals by allowing them more facilities.

"Many male employees feel they are substitutes for women when they go on long maternity leave and have to do double duty. This is creating rivalry and unpleasantness and must be sorted out by the Government for better policing," said a senior woman officer.

The writer is a veteran journalist and social activist

Nationalisation nostalgia: Balancing market realities and public promise



BIKASH NARAYAN
MISHRA

Nearly six decades ago, India experienced a significant transformation in its banking sector when the government nationalised 14 major private commercial banks.

This was immediately followed by the Lead Bank Scheme and the introduction of priority sector lending.

The move aimed to democratise banking and extend credit to the unbanked, with these banks then accounting for about 85 per cent of the country's deposits.

A newly independent nation needed to align its financial architecture with nation-building, and this laid the foundation for what is now popularly known as financial inclusion.

A second round of nationalisation in the 1980s paved the way for the next round of initiatives, such as stricter Priority Sector Lending (PSL) targets, driving the expansion of bank branches and credit into rural areas.

As India advances towards its Viksit Bharat 2047 vision, the paradigm has shifted again, with a growing need for larger, globally competitive banks that can lead not only in financing but also in technology.

Nearly six decades ago, India experienced a significant transformation in its banking sector when the government nationalised 14 major private commercial banks.

This was immediately followed by the Lead Bank Scheme and the introduction of priority sector lending.

The move aimed to democratise banking and extend credit to the unbanked, with these banks then accounting for about 85 per cent of the country's deposits.

A newly independent nation needed to align its financial architecture with nation-building, and this laid the foundation for what is now popularly known as financial inclusion.

A second round of nationalisation in the 1980s paved the way for the next round of initiatives, such as stricter Priority Sector Lending (PSL) targets, driving the expansion of bank branches and credit into rural areas.

As India advances towards its Viksit Bharat 2047 vision, the paradigm has shifted again, with a growing need for larger, globally competitive banks that can lead not only in financing but also in technology.

This has reignited the debate over whether the government should continue holding stakes in banks or allow market forces to drive their growth, scale and competitiveness.

The Last Mile...

While banks worldwide are rapidly adopting AI, the reality in a transitional economy like India is that the physical interface remains indispensable. With over 60 per cent of the population living in rural areas, routine payments and peer-to-peer transfers can be digitised, but complex credit decisions — such as crop loans, micro-business financing and retail credit for rural families — still require human judgement, local knowledge and face-to-face engagement.

The heavy lifting in these segments continues to be done by public sector banks. Until other lenders, including small finance banks and regional rural banks, achieve meaningful scale, there remains a case for continued government ownership to ensure sustained focus on these priority areas.

This becomes even more evident during



crises such as the ongoing West Asia conflict, when the government relies on banks to roll out support measures like the Emergency Credit Line Guarantee Scheme (ECLGS), largely implemented through public sector banks. Therefore, any decision on bank disinvestment should be calibrated rather than driven primarily by the objective of raising revenues to bridge the fiscal gap.

direct debt instruments, and competing with unregulated digital lending apps that often rely on predatory lending practices and coercive recovery methods.

At the same time, banks must modernise legacy systems and strengthen their ability to detect and respond to increasingly sophisticated, AI-driven cybersecurity threats. Smaller banks are unlikely to overcome these chal-

Small steps, bigger gains...

From taking banking to the remotest parts of the country and bringing over a billion people into the formal financial system to stabilising the economy during the COVID-19 pandemic and executing massive exercises such as demonetisation, the contribution of public sector banks remains unparalleled globally.

Today, the banking sector faces multiple challenges, including mobilising low-cost deposits, retaining corporate borrowers, who are increasingly turning to capital markets and

competing with unregulated digital lending apps that often rely on predatory lending practices and coercive recovery methods.

At the same time, banks must modernise legacy systems and strengthen their ability to detect and respond to increasingly sophisticated, AI-driven cybersecurity threats. Smaller banks are unlikely to overcome these chal-

lenges independently.

As the sector evolves, the focus should shift towards another round of structural mergers and amalgamations among public sector banks to improve cost efficiencies and achieve greater scale. However, such consolidation must be guided by a progressive and compassionate HR framework that safeguards the interests of employees and other stakeholders of the acquirer and acquired banks.

Conclusion

Bank nationalisation was never an end in itself; it was a response to the needs of its time. Today, India's banking sector stands at another inflection point, where the challenge is to balance financial inclusion with global competitiveness.

Rather than pursuing indiscriminate privatisation, policy should focus on creating stronger, technologically advanced and well-governed banks that continue to serve national priorities while competing effectively in global markets.

Carefully calibrated consolidation, continued investment in digital capabilities and a people-centric transition for employees can ensure that the banking system remains resilient, inclusive and capable of supporting India's ambition of becoming a developed nation by 2047.

The author is a former Senior Advisor to the Indian Banks Association



TRANSGLOBE
ADVISORS

Your Trusted Management Advisory

www.transglobeadvisors.in



Shiv Sena (UBT) challenges merger of rebel MPs to Eknath faction



The Shiv Sena (UBT) on Tuesday moved the Supreme Court challenging Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla's approval to the merger of its six MPs with the Shiv Sena led by Maharashtra Deputy Chief Minister Eknath Shinde.

Senior advocate Devadatt Kamat, appearing for the Shiv Sena (UBT), mentioned the matter before a bench of Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and Vipul M Pancholi.

Kamat urged the bench that the plea be listed for hearing on Wednesday.

"We will see," the CJI said.

Kamat told the bench that on July 18, the Speaker gave approval to the merger of six Shiv Sena (UBT) MPs with the Shiv Sena led by Shinde.

"The Speaker has recognised the merger (of six MPs)," he said, adding this has become a national phenomenon as MPs are merging with those against whom they had contested and won the elections.

Ahead of the Monsoon Session, Birla on July 18 approved the merger of six Shiv Sena (UBT) MPs with the Shiv Sena led by Shinde.

Official sources had said that with the merger of the six MPs, the strength of the Shiv Sena has gone up to 13.

A total of nine MPs had got elected on Shiv Sena (UBT) tickets, of which six have joined the Shiv Sena headed by Shinde.

The Shiv Sena (UBT) had argued before the Speaker that their rebel MPs should be disqualified as the defections fall under the anti-defection law. (PTI)

Uttarakhand HC seeks reply on UPP chief's detention

The high court here has directed the State Government to clarify on Tuesday the legal basis for detaining Uttarakhand Parivartan Party president Prabhat Dhyani on July 19.

The Government on Monday informed a bench of Justices Ravindra Maithani and Siddhartha Saha that Dhyani had been released.

The bench then asked the Government on what legal basis it had detained Dhyani and directed it to give an explanation on Tuesday.

According to the petition filed in this regard, Ramnagar Police detained Dhyani from a general coach at Rishikesh railway station at around 5 pm on Sunday when he was heading to New Delhi to join the protest rally called by activist Sonam Wangchuk.

Before leaving for Delhi, Dhyani shared a Facebook post expressing his party's support for Wangchuk's ongoing movement demanding reforms in the education system.

The Uttarakhand Parivartan Party would participate in the "Sansad Chalo" march from Jantar Mantar to Parliament on July 20, he wrote in the post, demanding the dismissal of Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan.

The petition alleged that after Dhyani's detention, the police did not provide any information about him to his family, forcing them to search for him throughout the night. Even after learning of his police custody, the family claimed, the police initially refused to release him.

Party general secretary Lalmani filed the habeas corpus petition and advocate Snigdha Tiwari argued the case. (PTI)

Court defers Sambhal row hearing to August 25

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Sambhal

A court in Chandausi on Tuesday postponed to August 25 the hearing in the Shahi Jama Masjid-Harihar temple dispute in the wake of the stay on proceedings by the Supreme Court.

The matter was listed for hearing before Civil Judge (Senior Division) Aditya Singh.

The Supreme Court had in November 2024 imposed an interim stay on the survey of the 16th-century Shahi Jama Masjid in Sambhal and halted all proceedings regarding the dispute in the local trial court.

Hindu side counsel Shrigopal Sharma said the matter was listed for hearing on Tuesday, but no proceedings took place as the case remains stayed following an



order of the Supreme Court. The court has now fixed August 25 as the next date of hearing, he said.

On the mediation process, Sharma said no settlement could be reached.

"We were ready for mediation, but the other side was not willing to accept our proposals," he said. Responding to a question on mediation, counsel for the Shahi Jama

SC questions Sonam's actions after attack on husband

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Tuesday questioned the conduct of Sonam Raghuvanshi, accused of killing her husband during their honeymoon in Meghalaya in 2025, while suggesting her to surrender and face trial in the case.

The accused, a resident of Indore in Madhya Pradesh, was arrested in June last year in connection with the killing of her businessman husband Raja Raghuvanshi.

The couple had gone missing while vacationing in Meghalaya's Sohra area on May 23 last year. Subsequently, Raja's body was found in a deep gorge on June 2, 2025. The police has alleged that Sonam conspired with hired assailants to kill her husband for financial gains. A bench of justices MM Sundresh and PB Varale was hearing a plea filed by the Meghalaya Government challenging the bail granted to Sonam.

"How do you explain your conduct? Their (police) case is that you along with deceased went to that place. The occurrence took place where he was attacked and died. What did you do there-



after? That's the primary issue. Secondly, regarding the grounds of arrest, did you raise it at the earliest point of time? the bench observed. The top court said it will either consider and pass an order on merits or direct Sonam to surrender and face trial.

"We are putting it to you because we don't want to catch you by surprise and at the same time you should also understand our mind. You just get instructions and come back to us," Justice Sundresh told the lawyer appearing for Sonam.

During the hearing, Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, appearing for the state government, submitted that the couple went to Meghalaya for honeymoon immediately after their marriage. "She lured her husband to be taken to an isolated

place in the hills. Three persons hired through her paramour were also following her. Eventually husband was killed, wife participated in it, and body was thrown down the gorge. He didn't die because of the throwing.

"He was killed first and then was thrown. That's what the investigation suggests. Respondent ran away. It was found that those three persons who helped her were at a particular place and hence were arrested. Now it has come on record that the paramour instructed her that now it is safer for her to surrender. At that time she was in Gazipur, she then surrendered before the police," Mehta said.

The law officer said Sonam was fully aware of the reasons for her arrest.

The counsel appearing for Sonam said this matter has

been given hype by the media and it is a case of circumstantial evidence.

The top court, however, made it clear that it was not inclined to examine the prosecution's allegations in detail at this stage.

The matter will now be heard on Thursday.

While hearing the matter on July 9, the apex court said it might refer to a larger bench the legal question whether the mere mention of a wrong statutory section in an arrest memo, specifically a typographical error, was sufficient to invalidate an arrest and grant bail to the accused in the case.

The top court had also indicated that it would closely examine whether the high court was justified in granting bail to Sonam on the grounds that the arrest memo contained a typographical error. On July 3, another bench of the top court had refused to stay the high court order granting bail. The solicitor general on July 9 raised the question whether the mere mention of a wrong statutory section in an arrest memo, specifically a typographical error, was sufficient to invalidate an arrest and grant bail in the "shocking" murder case.

Calcutta HC grants interim protection to TMC's Mahua Moitra in hate speech case

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Kolkata

The Calcutta High Court on Tuesday granted interim protection from coercive action to Trinamool Congress MP Mahua Moitra till October 5 in a "hate speech" case which she claimed is based on fabricated charges.

The Krishnanagar MP prayed before the court for an interim order preventing coercive police action in the case and quashing of proceedings against her in the case registered at Hogolberia police station in Nadia district. Justice Saugata Bhattacharyya directed Moitra to appear before the investigating officer on August 14 for questioning in the case.

The court directed that no coercive steps be taken against her till October 5 subject to compliance with the conditions alluded to until October or until further order, whichever is earlier.

Noting that the BNS (Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita) provisions applied to Moitra carry a maximum punishment



below seven years, the court observed that she is entitled to protection from coercive action provided she cooperates with the investigation.

Justice Bhattacharyya directed Moitra to cooperate with the probe and comply with police notices by appearing before the investigating officer. The court directed that the matter will be heard again on October 1.

On a prayer by her lawyer, Justice Bhattacharyya directed the police to ensure Moitra is

not subjected to egg-pelting when she appears before the investigating agency.

Her lawyer contended before the court that the punishment prescribed for the alleged offences is well below seven years and therefore, she is entitled to protection from any coercive action.

The petitioner stated that she will cooperate with the investigation.

Moitra's lawyer Ayan Bhattacharya stated that the Krishnanagar MP is at present in Delhi and will be engaged in the monsoon session of Parliament which is scheduled to continue till August 13.

He submitted that she will be able to appear before the investigating officer in virtual mode, if required, till August 13, and will be present personally on or from August 14.

Representing the state, Advocate General Surojit Nath Mitra opposed the petition, stating that Moitra had not complied with notices to appear before the investigating officer on four previous occasions.

AIIMS panel to examine Asaram health: SC

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Tuesday asked the director of AIIMS to constitute a medical board to assess the condition of self-styled godman Asaram, who has sought interim bail on medical grounds.

The Rajasthan High Court on May 27 upheld the conviction and life sentence awarded to the octogenarian in a case of rape of a minor in 2013. A bench of justices MM Sundresh and PB Varale asked the medical board to submit its report within a week.

During the hearing, Solicitor General Tushar Mehta submitted that just three months ago Asaram undertook journeys to Kashi Vishwanath and Ayodhya. "He got the bail on the ground that he was in vegetative state. But now he is roaming around," Mehta said. "We are not granting regular bail except if we are satisfied it is required on a medical ground. Let the report come," the bench

Court orders police to protect Mamata's Martyrs Day rally



PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Kolkata

The Calcutta High Court on Tuesday directed the Kolkata Police to ensure protection of the Mamata Banerjee-led TMC faction for holding its Martyrs' Day rally here, while hearing its allegation of vandalism of the programme stage.

Justice Saugata Bhattacharyya directed the Joint Commissioner (Headquarters) to file a report on July 31 when the matter will be heard again.

The court also directed that the stage and other meeting materials must be removed by 9 pm on Tuesday and that the police will provide security and assistance for dismantling the stage and disconnecting the loudspeakers this morning.

The Mamata Banerjee-led TMC faction moved the

High Court on Tuesday, stating that they made an urgent application before Acting Chief Justice Tapabrata Chakraborty at midnight alleging vandalism at their July 21 Martyrs' Day rally venue in front of Birla Planetarium here.

Seeking immediate intervention of the court and a modification of its July 15 order, the Mamata Banerjee-led TMC faction's lawyer Arka Nag stated that goons vandalised the stage and disconnected the loudspeakers this morning.

The lawyer said that in spite of direction by the court on July 15 to deploy adequate police personnel to ensure law and order, the people providing materials for making the stage and other electrical items were subjected to threats.



said. The counsel appearing for Asaram said the petitioner's case may be referred to the director of AIIMS, who may constitute a team of doctors to conduct a thorough examination.

He said the doctors can then submit a report on whether he should be admitted as a patient.

The high court had upheld Asaram's conviction in the case, but acquitted him of charges related to alleged gangrape and penetrative sexual assault on a child under the erstwhile Indian Penal Code and the Protection of Children from Sexual

Offences (POCSO) Act. However, the high court upheld his conviction under IPC Section 376(2)(F) pertaining to rape of the minor, thereby retaining the sentence of life imprisonment awarded by the trial court.

The high court had also upheld convictions under several other provisions, including Sections 342 (wrongful confinement), 370(4) (trafficking), 506 (criminal intimidation), 509 (insulting the modesty of a woman), 354(A) (sexual harassment) of the IPC, along with Sections 7/8 of the POCSO Act and Section 23 of the Juvenile Justice Act.

1996 Rajasthan blast: SC sets aside death penalty of convict, acquits another

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Three decades after a blast in a bus in Rajasthan's Dausa district killed 14 people, the Supreme Court on Tuesday set aside a convict's death penalty and ordered a fresh trial by a designated court. It also acquitted a lifer and dismissed the state government's appeals against the acquittal of six persons by the high court.

A bench of Justices Vikram Nath, Sanjay Karol and Sandeep Mehta set aside the 2019 judgement of the

Rajasthan High Court on death row convict Abdul Hameed citing ineffective assistance by his counsel.

Taking note of the passage of time since the May 22, 1996 blast in a bus going from Agra to Bikaner, the court directed a new trial designated by the high court chief justice. The endeavour should be to complete the trial in a year, the apex court said.

It said Hameed, a doctor, will be allowed a lawyer of his choice and the court will be presided over by a senior judge with considerable



experience of conducting session court trials.

Besides, the bench acquitted Pappu alias Salim, who was awarded life term by the

trial court, and dismissed the state government's appeals against the acquittal of six persons by the high court.

SC deletes part of Kerala HC order asking State Waqf Board to function under joint secretary

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

In a significant move, the Supreme Court on Tuesday directed deletion of a part of an interim order of the Kerala High Court which had asked the State Waqf Board to function under the supervision of a joint secretary.

Restoring the autonomy, a bench comprising Chief Justice Surya Kant and justices Joymalya Bagchi and Vipul M Pancholi modified the high court order and disposed of the appeals filed against the high court order.

"In view of the opening line of para 6 (of the high court order), whereunder the Board has been directed



to not undertake any capital expenditure etc. without leave of the court, we are satisfied that there is no necessity for retention of last line of para 6 of the order.

"Consequently, the direction that the Board shall function under supervision

of a joint secretary of the Government is hereby deleted. The joint secretary being a member of the Board should continue to function in that capacity. Matter coming up before the High Court tomorrow. We ask the High Court to expeditiously decide the case after giving a fair opportunity to the parties to file claims/counter-claims," the bench said in the order.

In its interim order on July 15, the Kerala High Court restrained the state Waqf Board from taking any major decision without its permission.

It had also directed that the Board shall not incur any capital expenditure or make any policy decision without

the express leave of the court, a senior advocate associated with the case said. The high court had passed the interim directions while hearing a batch of PILs alleging that the Board was functioning illegally as it did not include two non-Muslim members, as required under the Unified Waqf Management, Empowerment, Efficiency and Development Act.

Appearing for the Waqf Board, senior advocate Huzefa Ahmadi assailed the high court's order, submitting that the Board members had not even been served with copies of the petitions before such an "extraordinary order" was passed.



Workforce opportunity depends on skills

RAVIRAJA N SEETHARAM,
Vice-Chancellor, Chandigarh University

India will supply nearly a quarter of the world's incremental workforce over the next decade, more than any other country. The demographic dividend that policy-makers have long spoken of is no longer a distant prospect; it is arriving in real time, at the rate of roughly ten to twelve million new job-market entrants every year. Whether this abundance translates into national prosperity or into frustration depends less on how many degrees the country

awards and more on what those degrees are actually worth in an economy that no longer waits for education to catch up. The India Skills Report 2025 places the employability of Indian graduates at 54.81 per cent, an improvement over 33 per cent a decade ago, but still a sobering statistic. Roughly one in two graduates walks out of the university system unprepared for the workplace they are entering. Management education fares better at 78 per cent and engineering at 71.5 per cent, but the aggregate picture points to a persistent, structural mismatch between what

higher education produces and what industry needs. A second, faster shift now compounds that mismatch. The World Economic Forum's Future of Jobs Report 2025 estimates that 39 per cent of workers' core skills will change by 2030 and that 22 per cent of all jobs will be materially disrupted. Sixty-three per cent of employers cite the skills gap as the single biggest barrier to their transition plans, a striking figure because it identifies a problem that no amount of hiring can fix. You cannot hire your way out of a market where the required skills do not yet exist at scale.

The National Education Policy of 2020 anticipated much of this. Its provisions for mandatory internships, credit-based experiential learning and multidisciplinary curricula were, in effect, an attempt to institutionalise the very habits industry had been requesting for a generation. The UGC has since operationalised the framework, and AICTE has established more than four hundred IDEA Labs across technical institutions. But the policy scaffolding is only as strong as the industry participation that fills it. In too many institutions, industry engagement still means a guest lecture in the sixth

semester and a placement drive in the eighth - episodic touchpoints that fall well short of embedded co-creation. The institutions closing this gap are those treating industry not as a hiring channel but as a co-author of the learning experience itself. When Chandigarh University Online co-designs its Online MBA in Business Analytics with KPMG, embeds PwC India, PMI and Harvard Business Publishing certifications into its flagship Online MBA, and builds its Online MCA curriculum around Microsoft's certifications, the underlying premise is the same: if employers know which

skills they need, they must sit at the table when those skills are taught. None of this, individually, is sufficient. What is required is a shift in mindset: from viewing industry-academia collaboration as institutional goodwill to treating it as an infrastructure investment. India's demographic clock does not stop for good intentions. The next decade will decide whether the world's largest young workforce becomes an economic engine. That decision will not be made in a boardroom or a ministry. It will be made in the classroom and by industries standing beside universities.

Why culinary arts courses are the ideal choice for Gen Z



ARJUN SINGH DATTA,
Managing Director & COO, International Institute of Culinary Arts, New Delhi

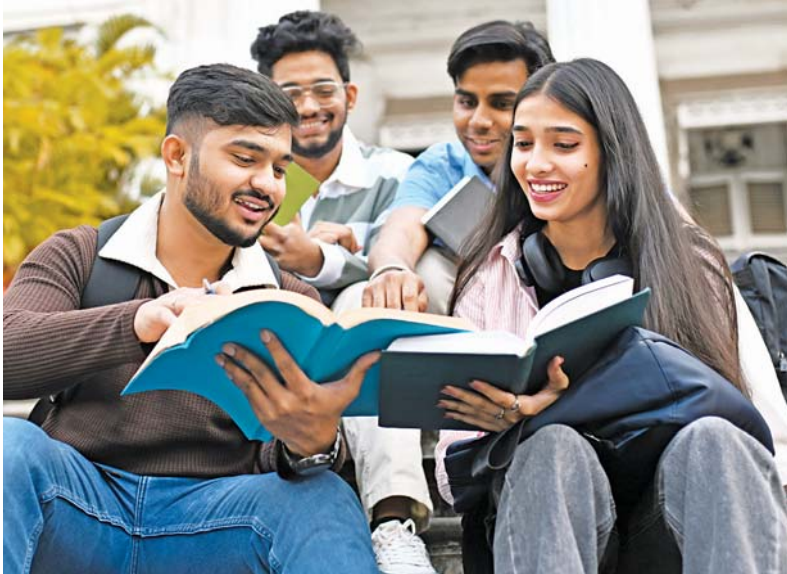
That is constantly changing and witnessing unprecedented trends across sectors, one sector that continues to grow at a rapid pace is the hospitality industry. For young people entering higher education today, hospitality is no longer a niche profession. According to the World Travel & Tourism Council (WTTC), it is one of India's largest employment generators, expected to support over 48 million jobs this year alone. Within this sector, there is growing demand for qualified culinary professionals. What makes this demand even more interesting is that many people still believe pursuing culinary education leads only to becoming a chef in a restaurant or hotel. Today, culinary professionals are choosing unconventional yet rewarding fields, including food technology, food styling and photography, entrepreneurship, and cruise liners. Gen Z wants purpose, not just a profession. Culinary education is becoming more widely accepted by this generation as it offers more than just a career. It connects directly with causes they care about, including sustainability, healthy eating, cultural preservation and community impact, while providing opportunities for creative expression. Additionally, Gen Z is increasingly opting for hands-on training over traditional

degrees, recognising that the future lies in skilling and employability. Globally, chefs continue to be in high demand. Australia's hospitality industry, for instance, has reported a critical shortage of chefs, with insufficient numbers of trained culinary professionals entering the workforce despite continued growth in accommodation and food services. Culinary education also goes beyond recipes. Students develop leadership, teamwork, communication, time management, adaptability and resilience — transferable skills valuable across professional settings. The profession is also increasingly considered 'future-proof'. While AI is transforming many professions, hospitality and culinary arts continue to depend on creativity, taste, human connection, emotional intelligence and individuality. At the International Institute of Culinary Arts (IICA), New Delhi, culinary education has evolved through global exposure, international qualifications from the UK and Australia, entrepreneurship, employability-focused programmes and an adaptive curriculum. Gen Z today is not merely measuring success through salaries but seeking purpose, creative expression, flexibility and freedom to shape their careers. Culinary education uniquely combines these aspirations, making it a natural choice for a generation eager to innovate and make its mark in an ever-changing world.

Building the foundation for CAT success

RAJAT KUMAR
Founder, TathaGat CAT Coaching

Every year, thousands of students begin their CAT preparation with a common goal: securing admission to India's leading business schools. The journey, however, extends far beyond solving aptitude questions or attempting mock tests. It demands discipline, consistency, strategic thinking, and an environment that encourages continuous learning. Among the many decisions an aspirant makes, selecting a coaching institute often shapes the entire preparation experience. A quick online search presents countless options, each promising exceptional outcomes. Marketing campaigns and attractive discounts often dominate the conversation, while the elements that truly influence learning receive far less attention. Looking beyond advertisements and evaluating an institute through an academic lens helps students make a more informed choice. Every successful coaching institute begins with its faculty. Experienced mentors bring perspectives developed over years of teaching students with varying strengths and learning styles. Their role extends beyond classroom instruction. They identify conceptual gaps, simplify difficult topics, encourage analytical thinking, and guide students through moments of self-doubt. Strong faculty members rarely rely on shortcuts or formula-driven teaching. Instead, they explain the logic behind solutions, enabling students to approach unfamiliar questions with confidence. Since CAT continues to evolve, conceptual clarity remains one of the strongest advantages an aspirant carries into the examination hall. Preparation becomes meaningful when learning focuses on understanding before speed. Students often chase faster techniques during the early stages of preparation, even though lasting improvement begins with mastering



EVERY YEAR, THOUSANDS OF STUDENTS BEGIN THEIR CAT PREPARATION WITH A COMMON GOAL: SECURING ADMISSION TO INDIA'S LEADING BUSINESS SCHOOLS

fundamentals. Institutes that dedicate adequate time to conceptual development usually produce students who remain comfortable across varying levels of difficulty. Classroom discussions should encourage questions, multiple approaches to solving problems, and intellectual curiosity. Every CAT aspirant follows a different academic journey. Some struggle with mathematics, while others require additional support in verbal ability or logical reasoning. Preparation therefore becomes more effective when mentors understand each student's individual requirements. Smaller batch sizes create opportunities for meaningful interaction between faculty and students. Personal guidance, regular doubt-resolution sessions, one-to-one feedback, and continuous academic monitoring allow aspirants to improve steadily throughout the preparation cycle.

Mock tests serve as learning tools rather than merely performance reports. Their real value emerges after the test concludes. Detailed analysis helps students understand recurring errors, identify weak areas, and refine examination strategy. Time management, question selection, accuracy, and decision-making gradually improve when every mock receives thoughtful review. Modern coaching institutes have strengthened this process through intelligent analytics. Advanced dashboards, section-wise performance reports, adaptive recommendations, and AI-driven insights enable students to monitor progress with greater precision. Academic culture influences performance more than many students realise. A classroom where discussions remain engaging, questions receive thoughtful responses, and healthy competition

thrives naturally creates motivated learners. Group discussions, collaborative problem-solving, and regular classroom participation encourage intellectual growth while sustaining motivation during the demanding months leading up to CAT. Today's aspirants also frequently balance college coursework, internships, professional responsibilities, or entrepreneurial pursuits alongside CAT preparation. Flexible learning formats therefore carry significant importance. A combination of classroom sessions, live online lectures, recorded classes, digital study material, practice portals, and faculty accessibility ensures that learning continues without interruption. Success stories deserve attention, although their true significance becomes evident when viewed alongside the academic processes that produced them. Consistently high-percentile achievers rarely emerge by chance. They develop within institutions that maintain rigorous teaching standards, continuous mentorship, structured testing, and academic discipline over many years. An institute's reputation gradually grows through generations of successful students whose experiences become its strongest endorsement. Such credibility carries greater weight than promotional campaigns or short-term marketing efforts. Choosing a coaching institute represents one of the earliest strategic decisions in the CAT journey. An institute built on experienced faculty, concept-driven learning, personalised mentorship, rigorous mock analysis, intelligent technology, and a culture of academic excellence creates an environment where students steadily grow into confident test-takers. CAT rewards clarity of thought, consistency, adaptability, and sound decision-making. These qualities continue to distinguish institutions that have earned lasting trust among serious MBA aspirants aiming to secure a place among India's finest business schools.

ROLE-PLAY, REAL GROWTH Why experiential learning works for kids

TARANDEEP SINGH SEKHON
Chief Business Officer, KidZania India

Children learn most effectively when they are actively doing, rather than passively listening. This fact is what makes experiential learning so powerful: it allows children to step into a role, make decisions, solve problems, and figure out how things work for themselves, rather than having everything explained to them. Role-play sits at the very heart of this idea because it turns learning into something children can really get their teeth into and remember for a long time. In today's world, where screens are everywhere, routines move in a blur, and attention spans seem to be shrinking all the time, hands-on experience matters more than ever. This kind of interaction is not just a fun spectator sport. It gives children the chance to participate and get their hands dirty, so to speak. They are not just watching the world go by; they are part of it. That makes the experience far more memorable because it connects imagination and reality in a way that feels authentic, engaging, and genuinely satisfying. Parents are drawn to this as well. Many are no longer simply looking for outings that will keep children occupied. They want experiences that have real depth, are screen-free, and feel



well worth the time and money they are spending. Experiential learning hits the nail on the head because it combines enjoyment with substance. It allows children to have a good time while also building confidence, curiosity, and that very important sense of achievement. Role-play is particularly effective because it helps children grasp the real world in a way that feels relatable. When a child becomes a firefighter for a day, or a pilot, or a lawyer, they are not just pretending. They are beginning to get a glimpse of respon-

sibility, teamwork, and how different professions contribute to everyday life. That is not always easy to explain in a classroom, but in an experience, it lands naturally. That is why edutainment has become so important for modern families.

Parents want more than just a fun distraction these days. They want their children to actually take something worthwhile away from the experience, whether that is learning something new, a bit more confidence, or simply the joy that comes from trying something new. The best experiences manage to do both. They are enjoyable as you go along, but they also leave behind something that lingers. Technology can add a lot to this, but only if it serves the experience rather than overwhelming it. Used well, augmented and virtual reality can make role-

play more immersive and more exciting for children growing up in a world where digital is simply part of everyday life. It can bring unfamiliar places to life in ways children can understand, or introduce ideas like safety, finance, or online awareness in a format that makes sense to them. But the key is that technology should be assistive rather than overpowering. The child should still be the one doing the learning, responding, and making sense of things for themselves. Seasonal events also play a valuable role in keeping the experience dynamic. Festivals and global occasions give families a reason to return and give children something new to look forward to. In many ways, this is what makes experiential marketing so effective. It is not just a one-time message. It is an ongoing relationship built through experiences that feel relevant, timely, and memorable. That is why screen-free, interactive, and meaningful experiences are no longer a nice-to-have. They are becoming an essential part of how families spend time together and how children build the skills they need for the future. Role-play works because it is simple, intuitive, and deeply human. It gives children the chance to learn by doing, and that remains one of the most powerful ways to grow.

CAMPUS CANVAS

Bringing responsible AI education to schools



TEAM AVENUES

As technology has evolved and made artificial intelligence an integral part of classrooms and our everyday lives, many educators are confronted with the pressing challenge of ensuring that the younger generation learns to use AI responsibly without becoming overly dependent on it. The Humain AI Literacy Mission (HAILM), which was recently launched at Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi, aims to address this challenge. HAILM introduces a holistic approach to AI literacy and prepares India's education ecosystem for the age of artificial intelligence with a human-centric approach. It offers an age-appropriate curriculum for Grades 3 to 12. This includes live sessions, an LMS, video lessons, interactive activities and classroom-ready learning materials. The programme helps schools adopt AI education

systematically, with its foundational-level learning available for free. By introducing AI as a general-purpose learning tool, it prioritises application over rote learning, encouraging learners not just to use AI but to think critically with it. However, despite the rise of artificial intelligence, education is incomplete without a human touch. To ensure AI is used ethically, teachers should act as mentors who motivate students, nurture ethical values and ensure accountability, while AI supports personalised learning by helping students identify and strengthen their weak areas. Our vision of a Viksit Bharat by 2047 can only emerge when the next generation of students and learners not only use and understand new technologies but also help shape them responsibly. To support this vision, HAILM acts as a structured pathway that will democratise access to AI education across India.

Public Notice
I am hereby informed to the general public that Late Dhanraj K. S. Rani was expired on dated 23.03.2026 and I am Late Hemant Kumar Kaushal also expired and I am behind legal heir namely Rajesh Kumar S/o Late Dhanraj K. S. Rani, Vinod Kumar Husband of Late Dhanraj K. S. Rani, Dipanshu Kaushal S/o Late Hemant Kumar Kaushal and Tisha Kaushal D/o Late Hemant Kumar Kaushal and Relinquishment Deed dated 08.05.2026 (Document No. 2026/15/7129, Bangalore 1, Vol. No. 17533, Page 169 to 178, registered dated 08.05.2026, SR-VI A) executed by Dipanshu

through e-tendering system/For viewing detailed E-NIT, downloading
in Electronic Tender, for any clarifications and/or due date extensions or
e www.mptenders.gov.in regularly/ Any clarifications and/or due date
issued on the website www.mptenders.gov.in only/
ELECTRICITY- SAVE POWER- SAVE MONEY //
Superintending Engineer (P&W)
O/o The Executive Director (Gen.)

Yours Truly, For GIC Housing Finance Ltd. sd/- Authorised Officer

The Prime Minister who brought Delhi closer to Assam

HIMANTA BISWA SARMA

A generation in Assam grew up with a quiet but persistent sense of alienation. It was taught, by experience as much as by politics, to believe that Delhi looked upon Assam and the North East with indifference. This was not entirely an imagined grievance. History gave it substance; policy often reinforced it. For decades, many in Assam felt that the region was remembered only in moments of crisis and forgotten in moments of national planning.

I belong to that generation. From my early years in public life, I had seen how deeply this feeling ran in Assam's collective mind. It shaped conversations, sharpened agitations and influenced aspirations. The belief that Delhi looked at Assam through the eyes of a step-mother had become part of our political vocabulary. It was not merely rhetoric; it was the emotional expression of a historical condition.

That is why the change of the last decade must be seen not only as a developmental shift, but as a civilisational correction.

When Narendra Modi became Prime Minister in 2014, something fundamental began to change in the relationship between Delhi and the North East. He did not treat the region as a remote frontier. He brought it into the centre of the national imagination. He spoke of the North East as Ashtalakshmi. He repeatedly emphasised Assam's strategic and cultural significance. More importantly, he translated this recognition into action.

And that has altered not only infrastructure, but mindset.

The generation that once internalised alienation has now witnessed engagement. The generation that followed has grown up with a different confidence. Young people in Assam today no longer instinctively assume that Delhi is distant or apathetic. They see their state as part of India's growth story, as a space of opportunity and as a region whose aspirations matter. This psychological shift may, in fact, be one of the Prime Minister's greatest contributions to Assam.

The development story that followed must be read against this backdrop.

There was a time when Assam had to agitate simply to ensure that its own crude oil was refined within the state. The memory of the refinery movement remains alive in our political consciousness. For long, Assam's resources flowed outward while local value addition remained limited. Today, that story is being rewritten. The Numaligarh Refinery expansion is moving ahead at full pace. Once completed, its annual refining capacity will rise from 3 million metric tonnes to 9 million metric tonnes. A new pipeline from Paradip to Numaligarh is nearing completion and fresh energy infrastructure is strengthening Assam's industrial capacity. What was once a symbol of extraction is becoming a symbol of transformation.

The same is true of industrial revival. Jagirod once stood as a reminder of decline. The silent Nagaon Paper Mill, the deserted quarters and the fading memory of industrial employment had all become part of Assam's landscape of disappointment. But history can turn. On that very soil, Tata Electronics is now building a



Assam Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma with Prime Minister Narendra Modi at an event in Guwahati

semiconductor facility with an investment of ₹27,000 crore. Assam, which once saw its industrial dreams rust away, is now entering the global semiconductor map. Few stories capture the journey from neglect to aspiration more vividly than this.

Peace, too, has been central to this new chapter.

There was a time when violence cast a long and fearful shadow over Assam. Insurgency, bomb blasts, kidnappings and gunfire had made uncertainty part of daily life. In such an atmosphere, tourism and investment were impossible to imagine. But the peace

accords signed in recent years—with Bodo groups, ULFA through the 2023 tripartite agreement and Karbi, Adivasi, Dimas and other organisations—have changed that reality. These agreements have not merely ended old conflicts; they have opened the door to new confidence. Peace has restored possibility.

And possibility has brought investment.

Advantage Assam 2.0, with participation from 75 countries, received investment commitments worth Rs. 5.18 lakh crore. Leading groups such as Reliance, Adani, Tata, Vedanta and Jindal are now

looking at Assam with seriousness and optimism. This would have seemed improbable not very long ago. Today, it is becoming routine. Assam is no longer waiting to be discovered; it is asserting itself as a destination.

Infrastructure tells the same story in concrete form.

For decades after Independence, the mighty Brahmaputra—Assam's lifeline and defining geography—was crossed by too few bridges. For nearly 70 years, there were only three bridges over it. In recent years, that picture has changed rapidly. New bridges have been completed, more are under construction and the geography of connectivity is being redrawn. The recently inaugurated Kumar Bhaskar Varma Setu is one such milestone. Projects like the Dhubri-Phulbari bridge, the JorhatMajuli bridge and the third Saraighat bridge speak of an Assam that is being physically integrated with unprecedented speed.

Healthcare has seen an equally important transformation. Assam, which once had to struggle for institutions of national importance, now hosts AIIMS Guwahati.

Medical colleges have expanded sharply, from seven in 2021 to fourteen now, with more under construction. The state has moved from scarcity to expansion, from dependency to capacity-building. In transport too, railway doubling, electrification, new Guwahati airport terminal, the upcoming tunnel under the Brahmaputra, the Kaziranga elevated corridor and the Guwahati Ring Road reflect a new scale of ambition.

But beyond these bridges, airports, factories and refineries lies a subtler change—the change in emotional distance.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi's most lasting contribution to Assam and the North East may well be that he narrowed the psychological gap between the region and the national capital. He did so not only through policy, but through gesture and presence. When he wears Assam's gamosa, it is not a routine courtesy. When he stays in Kaziranga, becoming the first Prime Minister to do so, it carries meaning. When he visits the North East repeatedly—more than 75 times—it sends a message that the region is not periph-

eral to India's destiny. That message has been heard.

Today, Assam stands more confident, more connected and more hopeful. The old language of abandonment is steadily giving way to the language of opportunity. The emotional arc has shifted—from grievance to participation, from distance to belonging.

On 10 June, Narendra Modi will create history by becoming the longest continuously serving elected Prime Minister of India, surpassing Jawaharlal Nehru's record. This is a moment of national significance. For Assam, it is also deeply personal. It is an occasion to acknowledge a leader under whose tenure the state has not only seen material progress, but also experienced a restoration of confidence in its place within the Indian Union.

I offer him my heartfelt congratulations on this historic milestone. I also pray to the Almighty to bless him with good health, long life and continued strength so that he may go on serving the nation with the same vision, conviction and dedication.

The writer is the Chief Minister of Assam

Harjit Grewal assumes office as chairman of National Commission for Minorities

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE

■ New Delhi



Harjit Singh Grewal has assumed office as the Chairman of the National Commission for Minorities on 21st July, 2026. His appointment marks the beginning of a renewed commitment towards promoting the welfare, inclusion, empowerment, and socio-economic development of minority communities. On his arrival at the Commission, he was warmly welcomed by Joint Secretary Dr AtyaNand and senior officers of the Commission.

Harjit Singh Grewal is a senior leader of the BharatiyaJanata Party (BJP). He previously served as the State Vice President of the BJP Punjab unit. With extensive experience in public life and organizational leadership, he has been actively involved in promoting social harmony,

public welfare, and inclusive development. He played a pivotal role in handling farmer protests crisis and served as a bridge between the Central Government and the protesting farmer unions.

S Munawari Begum, member NCM assumed office as the Vice Chairperson of the Commission on 20th July, 2026. She has served as the Vice President of the BJP Minority Morcha. With extensive experience in public service, she is expected to play a pivotal role in advancing the Commission's

mandate of protecting minority rights, promoting equal opportunities, and strengthening inclusive governance. She previously held the position of Vice-Chairperson for the Haj Committee of India.

The Commission has also welcomed Glenn Souza Ticio who assumed office as a Member representing the Christian community on 21st July, 2026.

Berjis Desai joined National Commission for Minorities on 10th March, 2026 as the Member representing the Parsi community.

Make environmental protection people's movement: CM Saini

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE

■ New Delhi

Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini said the Indian culture has always taught to respect and protect nature. Referring to Prime Minister Narendra Modi's nationwide campaign Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam, he said environmental conservation must be transformed into a people's movement. The CM was addressing a Youth Interaction and Tree Plantation Programme as the Chief Guest at the Apple Market in Pinjore, Panchkula. Earlier, accompanied by Forests, Environment and Wildlife Minister Rao Narbir Singh, the Chief Minister planted saplings at the Apple Market and flagged off four LED vans under Van Chetna Yatra-2026. These vans will travel across all districts of Haryana to encourage citizens to plant more trees and spread awareness about environmental conservation. During the programme, the Chief Minister also presented certificates to the youth who participated in the Thapli Nature Camp. Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare Minister Shyam Singh Rana and MLA Shakti Rani Sharma were also present.

The CM announced that 1,000 youth



Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini interacting with youth during the Yuva Samvad and Tree Plantation Programme at Panchkula district on Tuesday

would be included under the Mukhyamantri Teerth Yatra Yojana. He also announced the appointment of a Special Officer in the Chief Minister's Office to address issues concerning youth. He assured that Tikkar Taal in Morni would be developed as a mountaineering training centre on the lines of Manali, along with strengthening its supporting infrastructure. He further announced a dedicated electricity substation for the Pinjore Apple Market, as well as parking facilities and additional police security for vehicles bringing apples from HP.

The Chief Minister said planting a sapling is easy, but nurturing it into a tree is a much greater responsibility. He urged every young person to

plant and care for at least one sapling on their birthday, their parents' birthdays or any special occasion, adding that such a collective effort would make Haryana greener.

Quoting Prime Minister Narendra Modi, he said, "Just as we honour our biological mother, we must also respect Mother Earth, who nurtures and sustains us." He called upon every citizen to plant at least one tree for Mother Earth and inspire others to do the same. He emphasised that development and environmental conservation are not contradictory but complementary. Haryana's development, he said, must be sustainable, protect natural resources, secure the future of coming generations and

maintain ecological balance while ensuring economic progress.

He said the Thapli Nature Camp had given young participants an opportunity to closely experience nature, and these youth would now become ambassadors of environmental awareness in society. He also appreciated the efforts of hundreds of environmental enthusiasts who have inspired others through tree plantation drives. The CM said that a youth who understands and values his heritage becomes architect of future.

The CM said the government has launched the Pran Vayu Devta Pension Scheme for trees that are more than 75 years old. Under the scheme, financial assistance of ₹3,000 per tree per year is being provided for their care and maintenance. He said such old trees deserve gratitude and special protection for environmental services they provide. He further said state government has initiated the establishment of Oxy-Vans over an area ranging from 5 to 100 acres at every district headquarters to make Haryana greener. These Oxy-Vans will include facilities such as walking tracks and cycling tracks. While Oxy-Van at Karnal has been completed, work is in progress in Panchkula.

DAILY SUDOKU

6	4			1	2			
7			6		5			
3	1							
9				5	1	4		
2							1	
		5	6	9				8
						2	8	
	4		3				7	
1	2			8	5			

DIFFICULTY RATING: ★★☆☆☆

HOW TO SOLVE IT

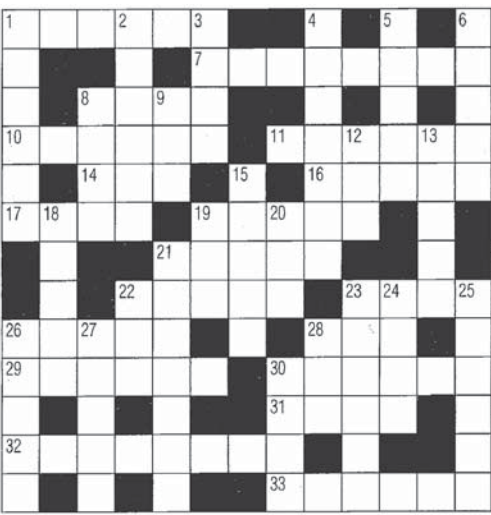
Sudoku is a logic puzzle where you fill a 9×9 grid so that numbers 1 to 9 appear once in every row, column, and 3×3 box, using elimination and logical deduction—no maths involved.



SOLUTION (21.7.26)

1	6	4	7	5	2	9	3	8
7	2	3	9	4	8	5	6	1
9	5	8	6	1	3	2	4	7
5	3	1	2	9	4	8	7	6
6	8	2	3	7	5	1	9	4
4	7	9	8	6	1	3	2	5
3	1	5	4	2	6	7	8	9
2	9	6	5	8	7	4	1	3
8	4	7	1	3	9	6	5	2

DOUBLE CROSSWORD WEDNESDAY | JULY 22, 2026



ACROSS

- 1 It's a sweet Oriental vessel to an alien (6)
- 7 To start, tie it in a knot! (8)
- 8 It's a bit fishy that Gillian's lost her boy (4)
- 10 Jack has to hit the mark (6)
- 11 Domain without borders (6)
- 14 In the Bahamas, it can express surprise (3)
- 16 Standard Anglo Saxon soldiers, in short (5)
- 17 One of those in a costly pile-up? (4)
- 19 Amassed a fortune at the trading centre (5)
- 21 Person eating with much noise and little

DOWN

- 1 Spurned, Jack's girlfriend is said to have gone with Ted (6)
- 2 Horsy looking fellow on board (6)
- 3 Tip it playfully over an officer! (4)
- 4 It's a corking preventative! (7)
- 5 A term for mum (5)
- 6 We take a little boy around town (5)
- 8 Pick up very quickly (4)
- 9 The field to be in credit, that's clear (3)
- 12 Caught in possession? (3)
- 13 His Bolero might seem a bit of a marvel (5)
- 15 It's better to be the beak (5)
- 18 Provide with a new, wonderful part (5)

ceremony (5)

- 22 Being soft on Enid, perhaps, carried a torch (5)
- 23 Does this sound a note of familiarity? (4)
- 26 Thus the Spanish produce individual performances (5)
- 28 In making a scene, talk a lot (3)
- 29 Out West, a small person may be called a little jerk (6)
- 30 Man of stone (6)
- 31 Carry out an order to the very end (4)
- 32 To get the stuff, tear mail apart! (8)
- 33 Doing one's best to be a nuisance (6)

19 Something stuck in a good way? (3)

- 20 Was first in the field of racing (3)
- 21 Perceive a way to rescind (7)
- 22 Potato vessel? (3)
- 23 In shameful style in a bachelor's place (4)
- 24 Make visual contact with a key agent (5)
- 25 Tempting one to start lunch with a wry grin (6)
- 26 Put one's foot down to make an impression? (5)
- 27 Is inclined to make enumerations (5)
- 28 Too much talk of the brave heart in Britain (3)
- 30 Write out a novel's ending so as to shock! (4)

‘BANKS REPORTED FRAUD OF ₹1.42 LAKH CRORE IN 5 YEARS’



PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ New Delhi

Banks and financial institutions reported fraud of ₹1.42 lakh crore in the last five financial years and recovery to the tune of ₹6,389 crore was made during the period, Parliament was informed on Tuesday.

In a written reply to Rajya Sabha, Minister of State for Finance Pankaj Chaudhary said his ministry has been apprised by RBI that it is not maintaining information pertaining to the action taken against wilful defaulters.

However, as per data reported by public sector banks, as on March 31, 2026, suits for recovery were filed against 15,577 wilful defaulters and action under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest (SARFAESI) Act was initiated in 10,894 cases. Besides, FIRs were filed in 7,173 cases.

Public sector banks, as on March 31, 2026, have recovered an aggregate amount of ₹52,360 crore from wilful defaulters.

Further, he said, recovery in accounts classified as fraud is an ongoing process and as per RBI data, an aggregate recovery of ₹6,389 crore was made in such accounts during the last five financial years.

“As per Reserve Bank of India (RBI) inputs, during the last five financial years, an aggregate amount involved in frauds, based on the date of reporting in Commercial Banks and All India Financial Institutions was ₹1,42,112 crore,” Chaudhary said.

Commercial Banks include public sector banks, private sector banks, foreign banks, small finance banks, payments banks, local area banks.

In reply to another question, Chaudhary said, in FY26, 18,021 complaints were received against banks regarding recovery agencies, which was more than double of 8,623 complaints in the previous year.

To strengthen safeguards and accountability to protect borrowers from coercive recovery practices, RBI has directed banks, vide a notification dated November 28, 2025, that they shall not resort to undue harassment, and have a due diligence process for engagement of recovery agents, he said.

Several trains regulated due to power blocks on Roza-Alamnagar section

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ New Delhi

Due to traffic cum power blocks for commissioning of Double Distant signaling work on Roza Jn — Alamnagar section over Moradabad Division, several trains shall be regulated, Northern Railway said in a press release.

The press release said that 22490 Meerut City — Varanasi JCO on July 30 will be regulated 60 minutes enroute, 14022 Anand Vihar Terminal — Purulia Jn. JCO on July 30 will be regulated 60 minutes enroute, 22454 Meerut City — Lucknow Jn JCO will be regulated 60 minutes enroute on July 30, 15652 JammuTavi — Guwahati JCO will be regulated 30 minutes enroute on July 29 and 15074 Tanakpur — Singrauli JCO will be regulated 30 minutes enroute on July 30.



VCSG UTTARAKHAND UNIVERSITY OF HORTICULTURE & FORESTRY
BHARSAR, PAURI GARHWAL 246123

VACANCY

Few Positions of the university are advertised in the University for recruitment. For details, please visit Website i.e. www.uuhf.ac.in

Registrar
VCSG UUHF, Bharsar, Pauri Garhwal

कार्यालय नगर निगम, रुड़की, जनपद- हस्तिार (उत्तराखण्ड)

दूरभाष नम्बर : 01332-227666 ई-मेल आईडी: nagarnigamroorkee@gmail.com

Press Note E-Tender Notice				
"Nagar Nigam Roorkee invites sealed bids from eligible agencies for the Treatment of Legacy Waste through Bio-Remediation and Bio-Mining Technologies at the Municipal Dumpsite, Roorkee, Uttarakhand. Interested bidders may submit their proposals as per the terms and conditions prescribed in the Request for Proposal (RFP). The detailed RFP containing eligibility criteria, scope of work, bid schedule and other conditions is available with the tender document." Tenders Details are given below.				
Sr. No.	Bid Publish Date	Bid Submission Starting Date	Bid Submission End Date	Bid Opening Date
01	22/07/2026	29/07/2026	06/08/2026	06/08/2026
Note:- 1- For More Details visit to www.uktenders.gov.in . 2- All the Bidder should read the terms & Conditions of the tender before the filling. As per the tender conditions technical analysis will be done by section. पत्रांक: 192/स्वा03नु0/ई0-निविदा/न0नि0रु0/2026-27 दिनांक : 21.07.2026				
सहायक नगर आयुक्ती नगर निगम, रुड़की				

BRIEFLY

Topps to release trading card with Messi holding infant Yamal



Topps is creating a trading card of what became a famous photo during the World Cup of Argentina's Lionel Messi holding Spain's Lamine Yamal, the company said Monday. Messi, whom many consider soccer's greatest player, was photographed holding Yamal, then an infant and now a 19-year-old rising star.

The two met in Sunday's final, with Yamal and Spain defeating Messi and Argentina 1-0.

That game was a potential changing of the guard with the 39-year-old Messi perhaps playing in his final World Cup. Playing for Barcelona at the time of the initial meeting with Yamal, Messi took part in a fundraising drive for UNICEF and wound up holding the player who could be the future face of the sport. Yamal has followed in Messi's footsteps by becoming Barcelona's standout player.

Indians start well at World Junior Squash

Indian top seed Anahat Singh eased past Kiwi qualifier Lilly Wilson to enter the women's singles second round of the World Squash Junior Individual Championships in Ontario, Canada. The Indian trio of Aryaveer Dewan Yusha Nafees and Gurveer Singh advanced to the men's singles third round on the opening day of the competition on Monday.



Purav Rambhia took Ronnie Hickling the distance but the Englishman prevailed in a thrilling five-game second round clash. In women's first round, Anika Dubey beat Japan's Anna Kuwahara in straight games and Saanvi Kalanki edged out the Netherlands' Elcke Mols in a five-game battle.

Ryan Fox and his road to British Open champion

DOUG FERGUSON
■ Southport (England)

Ryan Fox is the British Open champion, and it's going to take time for that to sink in no matter how many times he watches the replay of a 12-foot birdie putt on the final hole, or how many times he stares at his name on the base of the silver claret jug.

"I don't know if it's something I've dreamed of. I don't know if it's something I ever thought was possible," Fox said after his one-shot victory Sunday. "But we're here now." It's how he got there that sets him apart from so many other names on golf's oldest trophy.

Never mind the son of All

Blacks rugby great Grant Fox didn't play golf competitively until he was 17, or that all he ever wanted was to have a card on any tour. Fox had never finished better than a tie for 16th in 28 majors before arriving at Royal Birkdale.

And to think Fox nearly quit before he even got started.

It was his second year on the PGA Tour of Australasia and Fox was about to lose his card with two events left in the season when he went to the Australian Masters at Royal Melbourne.

"My dad came over and caddied for me, and he said to me, Why do you play this game? And I said, Well, it's supposed to be fun." But it



wasn't really very fun at the time," Fox said Sunday night, the silver claret jug at his side. "He goes, Well, let's just go out this week try to have some fun."

He did well enough to keep his card, and before long Fox was on his way on a path that

culminated with a putt he only imagined in his dreams — a 12-foot birdie, the final shot of the 154th Open, middle of the cup, arms raised, face awash in joy and disbelief.

"Everyone practices on the green - you've got a putt to

Both India and Zimbabwe will have equal chance in T20I series, says Sikandar Raza

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
■ Harare

Zimbabwe T20 captain Sikandar Raza has dismissed any talk of India being overwhelming favourites, insisting the upcoming three-match T20I series will be a closely-fought contest with both teams having an equal chance of emerging victorious. The series gets underway on Thursday, with Zimbabwe sensing an opportunity against an Indian side looking to bounce back from a diffi-



cult white-ball tour of Ireland and England.

India endured a 0-2 T20I series defeat to Ireland in

win a major championship, to win The Open. It's not like that in real life. It's not a very comfortable feeling," Fox said. "It's certainly very enjoyable when you see it go in."

Royal Birkdale now has two Open champions from Down Under. Fox joined Ian Baker-Finch, the Australian who won on these links in 1991 and who was here this week to promote his book, "To Hell and Back."

It wasn't that way for Fox. He was more of a slow, steady rise. He had three wins on the PGA Tour of Australasia, three more on the European tour (including the BMW PGA Championship) and two wins on the PGA Tour last year that included a

playoff win over Sam Burns in the Canadian Open.

"Why it's a slow burn? I don't know," Fox said as he contemplated his timeline — European tour rookie at age 30, PGA Tour rookie at age 37, major champion at age 39. He's the oldest first-time major champion since Henrik Stenson was 40 at Royal Troon in 2016.

"If you'd have given me my career up till yesterday when I first turned pro, I would have jumped at it," he said. "Now I probably would have killed people for it."

Fox showed plenty of resiliency in the final round of a British Open that kept a record crowd guessing until the very end.

Public Notice / General Information

The general public is hereby informed that my client has lawfully purchased the below described land/property/agricultural land from 1. Vidha Devi urf Vidya Devi urf Vidhya Devi W/o Jai Bhagwan Yadav resident 01, Bhut Mohalla, Sector-52, Wazirabad(75),Gurgaon Haryana-122003 2. Pooja W/o Dharmveer resident 110, Jamna Mohlla Mohna(204), Faridabad Haryana – 121004 3. Radha W/o Raj Kumar resident House No. 490, Deegh, Digh(56), Faridabad Haryana 121004 collectively referred as "Sellers"

The details of the said land of the Seller are as under Khewat/Khata No. 3481/3447 Rect. No. 258 Killa No. 201/2(-7) Rect. No. 259 Killa No. 15/2(4-0) 16(7-14) 25(8-0) Rect. No. 267 Killa No. 5/1(5-7) total fields 5 land measuring 26 Kanal 8 Marla Salam Fard Jamabandi for the year 2021-2022 and Mutation No. 22284 ("Seller No. 1") Khewat/Khata No. 2997/2962 Rect. No. 193 Killa No. 18(7-13) 22/2(3-4) Rect. No. 201 Killa No. 3(7-3) 4(7-9) 5/2(4-17) total fields 5 land measuring 30 Kanal 6 Marla having share to the extent of 1/8 share which comes to 3 Kanal 15.75 Marla and Khewat/Khata No. 2245/1/2224/1 Rect. No. 193 Killa No. 23(7-13) Rect. No. 201 Killa No. 5/3(2-0) total fields 2 land measuring 9 Kanal 13 Marla having share to the extent of 1/8 share which comes to 1 Kanal 4.12 Marla i.e. total land measuring 4 Kanal 19.87 Marla ("Seller No.2,3") Fard Jamabandi for the year 2021-2022 and Mutation No. 23500 situated in the revenue estate of Village Mandkola, Tehsil Hathin, District Palwal (Haryana) ("Scheduled Property/Land")

The said purchase has been undertaken by my Client with due care and proper due diligence. The said Public notice is being issued, so as to ascertain and invite disclosure of any hidden claims, rights, or disputes, if any, relating to the said Scheduled Property/Land.

The Seller had further declared that the said Scheduled Property/Land is completely free from all kinds of encumbrances including but not limited to charges, mortgages, loans, claims, disputes, litigations, attachments, stay orders, ceiling proceedings, acquisition, surplus land, government dues, or any third-party rights or claims whatsoever, and that the title of the Scheduled Property/Land is clear, clean, and marketable. The Seller had further represented and warranted that the Seller has clear, valid, absolute, and marketable right, title, interest and ownership and was in actual, vacant, peaceful physical and legal possession of the said Scheduled Property/Land and that no prior, existing, or subsisting agreement, transaction, understanding, or arrangement of any nature whatsoever, whether oral or written, in respect of the said Scheduled Property/Land has been entered into with any third party in respect thereof. It was also declared that no case, proceeding, or dispute in respect of the said Scheduled Property/Land is pending before any court, tribunal, or any competent legal or quasi-legal authority/forum.

Therefore, any person, bank, financial institution, government department, or any other party, firm, company, or entity, who has or claims to have any valid, legal, or equitable right, title, interest, claim, demand, charge, or encumbrance of any nature whatsoever in respect of the said Scheduled Property/Land—whether by way of sale, gift, lease, tenancy, license, exchange, partition, mortgage, lien, inheritance, succession, agreement, litigation, decree, stay order, possession, or otherwise—shall intimate the undersigned in writing, along with full particulars of such claim/objection and supporting documentary evidence, within fifteen (15) days from the date of publication of this notice.

In case no information or objection is received within the stipulated period, it shall be conclusively and lawfully presumed that there exists no encumbrances including but not limited to third-party claim, right, or dispute etc. in respect of the said Scheduled Property/Land and my client shall be legally deemed to have clear, valid, absolute, and marketable right, title, interest and ownership therein along with actual, vacant, peaceful physical and legal possession thereon, entitling my Client to lawfully proceed, sell and deal with the Scheduled Property/Land.

Thereafter, any such claim, objection, or dispute shall be treated as legally untenable, deemed to have been waived, and my client shall not be held liable for the same in any civil or criminal proceedings before any court, tribunal, or any competent legal or quasi-legal authority/forum.

The Scheduled Property/Land shall be deemed to include all rights, easements, pathways, appurtenances, standing crops, trees, plants, constructions, fences, boundary walls, etc. attached thereto.

The general public is hereby cautioned not to deal or enter into any transaction concerning the Schedule Property/Land with any person, party, or entity, failing which such transaction shall be at their own cost, risk and consequences.

This public notice is issued on behalf of my Client with complete bona-fide, transparency, and good faith so as to safeguard my client against any future allegations of fraud, misrepresentation, or collusion or any other allegations whatsoever in relation to the Schedule property. This notice is being issued without prejudice to any of the legal rights, contentions and remedies available to my client under applicable law

Durga Lal - Advocate, Law Consultant Office,
Office No. 57 Nehru Ground Near Main Post Office,
B.K. Chowk, NIT Faridabad, Haryana. ENROL. No. PH/5563/2022
Mobile No.7303834091, Email- lawconsultantsoffice@gmail.com

Public Notice / General Information

The general public is hereby informed that my client has lawfully purchased the below described land/property/agricultural land from 1. Nisha Gaba W/o Sanjeev Gaba resident 30/28-28A, West Patel Nagar, Patel Nagar West, Central Delhi, Delhi – 110008 2. Rajpal S/o Manohar Lal resident Hayatpur(114), Garhi Harsaru Gurgaon Haryana - 122505 collectively referred as "Sellers"

The details of the said land of the Seller are as under Khewat/Khata No. 136/168 Rect. No. 28 Killa No. 13 land measuring 8 Kanal 0 Marla Salam Share Fard Jamabandi for the year 2023-2024 and Mutation No. 2711 ("Seller No.1") Khewat/Khata No. 23/29 Rect. No. 7 Killa No. 17(8-0) Rect. No. 15 Killa No. 14(8-0) total fields 2 land measuring 16 Kanal 0 Marla having share to the extent of 1/2 share which comes to 8 Kanal 0 Marla and Khewat/Khata No. 26/32 Rect. No. 7 Killa No. 14 land measuring 8 Kanal 0 Marla having share to the extent of 1/3 share which comes to 2 Kanal 13.33 Marla and Khewat/Khata No. 177/210 Rect. No. 19 Killa No. 6(3-10) 14(2-8) 15(7-17) 16(8-0) 17(7-12) Rect. No. 28 Killa No. 4/2(1-6) 5(8-0) total fields 7 land measuring 39 Kanal 3 Marla having share to the extent of 3/76799/651000 share which comes to 22 Kanal 13.20 Marla i.e. total land measuring of all Khewat 33 Kanal 6.53 Marla Fard Jamabandi for the year 2023-2024 and Mutation No. 2712 ("Seller No. 2") situated in the revenue estate of Village Pondri, Tehsil Hathin, District Palwal (Haryana) ("Scheduled Property/Land")

The said purchase has been undertaken by my Client with due care and proper due diligence. The said Public notice is being issued, so as to ascertain and invite disclosure of any hidden claims, rights, or disputes, if any, relating to the said Scheduled Property/Land.

The Seller had further declared that the said Scheduled Property/Land is completely free from all kinds of encumbrances including but not limited to charges, mortgages, loans, claims, disputes, litigations, attachments, stay orders, ceiling proceedings, acquisition, surplus land, government dues, or any third-party rights or claims whatsoever, and that the title of the Scheduled Property/Land is clear, clean, and marketable. The Seller had further represented and warranted that the Seller has clear, valid, absolute, and marketable right, title, interest and ownership and was in actual, vacant, peaceful physical and legal possession of the said Scheduled Property/Land and that no prior, existing, or subsisting agreement, transaction, understanding, or arrangement of any nature whatsoever, whether oral or written, in respect of the said Scheduled Property/Land has been entered into with any third party in respect thereof. It was also declared that no case, proceeding, or dispute in respect of the said Scheduled Property/Land is pending before any court, tribunal, or any competent legal or quasi-legal authority/forum.

Therefore, any person, bank, financial institution, government department, or any other party, firm, company, or entity, who has or claims to have any valid, legal, or equitable right, title, interest, claim, demand, charge, or encumbrance of any nature whatsoever in respect of the said Scheduled Property/Land—whether by way of sale, gift, lease, tenancy, license, exchange, partition, mortgage, lien, inheritance, succession, agreement, litigation, decree, stay order, possession, or otherwise—shall intimate the undersigned in writing, along with full particulars of such claim/objection and supporting documentary evidence, within fifteen (15) days from the date of publication of this notice.

In case no information or objection is received within the stipulated period, it shall be conclusively and lawfully presumed that there exists no encumbrances including but not limited to third-party claim, right, or dispute etc. in respect of the said Scheduled Property/Land and my client shall be legally deemed to have clear, valid, absolute, and marketable right, title, interest and ownership therein along with actual,vacant, peaceful physical and legal possession thereon, entitling my Client to lawfully proceed, sell and deal with the Scheduled Property/Land.

Thereafter, any such claim, objection, or dispute shall be treated as legally untenable, deemed to have been waived, and my client shall not be held liable for the same in any civil or criminal proceedings before any court, tribunal, or any competent legal or quasi-legal authority/forum.

The Scheduled Property/Land shall be deemed to include all rights, easements, pathways, appurtenances, standing crops, trees, plants, constructions, fences, boundary walls, etc. attached thereto.

The general public is hereby cautioned not to deal or enter into any transaction concerning the Schedule Property/Land with any person, party, or entity, failing which such transaction shall be at their own cost, risk and consequences.

This public notice is issued on behalf of my Client with complete bona-fide, transparency, and good faith so as to safeguard my client against any future allegations of fraud, misrepresentation, or collusion or any other allegations whatsoever in relation to the Schedule property. This notice is being issued without prejudice to any of the legal rights, contentions and remedies available to my client under applicable law

Durga Lal - Advocate, Law Consultant Office,
Office No. 57 Nehru Ground Near Main Post Office,
B.K. Chowk, NIT Faridabad, Haryana. ENROL. No. PH/5563/2022
Mobile No.7303834091, Email- lawconsultantsoffice@gmail.com

Public Notice / General Information

The general public is hereby informed that my client has lawfully purchased the below described land/property/agricultural land from 1. Raj Dagar W/o Baljeet Singh Dagar resident 123 Kriti Nagar Sector 15, Part – 1 Gurgaon Haryana – 122001 2. Shishwati W/o Raghu Nath urf Raghunath Singh resident Shyam Patti Near Agarwal School, Mandkola (217), Palwal Haryana – 121103 3. Lekhraj S/o Ram Singh resident Village – Jawan, Jawan(59), Ballabgarh, Faridabad Haryana – 121004 4. Virender Singh S/o Ram Singh resident Near KMP School, Village Jawa Ward No 12 Jawan(59), Faridabad Ballabgarh Haryana – 121004 5. Sunita Dagar W/o Virender Singh resident Makan No. 1309, Ward No. 10, Shyam Pattee Mandkola(217), Palwal Haryana 121103 collectively referred as "Sellers"

The details of the said land of the Seller are as under Khewat/Khata No. 2102/2084 Rect. No. 233 Killa No. 3(8-0) 4(8-0) 7(8-0) 12/3(6-3) total fields 4 land measuring 30 Kanal 3 Marla having share to the extent of 80/1857 share which comes to 1 Kanal 5.97 Marla and Khewat/Khata No. 2099/2081 Rect. No. 225 Killa No. 13(7-13) 14/1(2-3) 14/2(4-5) 14/3(1-12) 15(8-0) 16(8-0) 17(8-0) 18(7-13) 23(7-9) 24(7-9) total fields 10 land measuring 62 Kanal 4 Marla having share to the extent of 80/1857 share which comes to 2 Kanal 13.59 Marla i.e. total land measuring 3 Kanal 19.56 Marla as per Fard Jamabandi for the year 2021-2022 and Mutation No. 21956 ("Seller No.1") Khewat/Khata No. 2840/2805 Rect. No. 124 Killa No. 19min-north land measuring 4 Kanal 0 Marla Salam ("Seller No.2") Khewat/Khata No. 1589/1576 Rect. No. 155 Killa No. 15/2(6-8) 16/1(3-4) Rect. No. 164 Killa No. 18/1(4-13) total fields 3 land measuring 14 Kanal 5 Marla having share to the extent of 7/24 share which comes to 4 Kanal 3.12 Marla ("Seller No. 3,4,5") as per Fard Jamabandi for the year 2021-2022 vide Mutation No. 23192, 20918 situated in the revenue estate of Village Mandkola, Tehsil Hathin, District Palwal (Haryana) ("Scheduled Property/Land")

The said purchase has been undertaken by my Client with due care and proper due diligence. The said Public notice is being issued, so as to ascertain and invite disclosure of any hidden claims, rights, or disputes, if any, relating to the said Scheduled Property/Land.

The Seller had further declared that the said Scheduled Property/Land is completely free from all kinds of encumbrances including but not limited to charges, mortgages, loans, claims, disputes, litigations, attachments, stay orders, ceiling proceedings, acquisition, surplus land, government dues, or any third-party rights or claims whatsoever, and that the title of the Scheduled Property/Land is clear, clean, and marketable. The Seller had further represented and warranted that the Seller has clear, valid, absolute, and marketable right, title, interest and ownership and was in actual, vacant, peaceful physical and legal possession of the said Scheduled Property/Land and that no prior, existing, or subsisting agreement, transaction, understanding, or arrangement of any nature whatsoever, whether oral or written, in respect of the said Scheduled Property/Land has been entered into with any third party in respect thereof. It was also declared that no case, proceeding, or dispute in respect of the said Scheduled Property/Land is pending before any court, tribunal, or any competent legal or quasi-legal authority/forum.

Therefore, any person, bank, financial institution, government department, or any other party, firm, company, or entity, who has or claims to have any valid, legal, or equitable right, title, interest, claim, demand, charge, or encumbrance of any nature whatsoever in respect of the said Scheduled Property/Land—whether by way of sale, gift, lease, tenancy, license, exchange, partition, mortgage, lien, inheritance, succession, agreement, litigation, decree, stay order, possession, or otherwise—shall intimate the undersigned in writing, along with full particulars of such claim/objection and supporting documentary evidence, within fifteen (15) days from the date of publication of this notice.

In case no information or objection is received within the stipulated period, it shall be conclusively and lawfully presumed that there exists no encumbrances including but not limited to third-party claim, right, or dispute etc. in respect of the said Scheduled Property/Land and my client shall be legally deemed to have clear, valid, absolute, and marketable right, title, interest and ownership therein along with actual, vacant, peaceful physical and legal possession thereon, entitling my Client to lawfully proceed, sell and deal with the Scheduled Property/Land.

Thereafter, any such claim, objection, or dispute shall be treated as legally untenable, deemed to have been waived, and my client shall not be held liable for the same in any civil or criminal proceedings before any court, tribunal, or any competent legal or quasi-legal authority/forum.

The Scheduled Property/Land shall be deemed to include all rights, easements, pathways, appurtenances, standing crops, trees, plants, constructions, fences, boundary walls, etc. attached thereto.

The general public is hereby cautioned not to deal or enter into any transaction concerning the Schedule Property/Land with any person, party, or entity, failing which such transaction shall be at their own cost, risk and consequences.

This public notice is issued on behalf of my Client with complete bona-fide, transparency, and good faith so as to safeguard my client against any future allegations of fraud, misrepresentation, or collusion or any other allegations whatsoever in relation to the Schedule property. This notice is being issued without prejudice to any of the legal rights, contentions and remedies available to my client under applicable law

Durga Lal - Advocate, Law Consultant Office,
Office No. 57 Nehru Ground Near Main Post Office,
B.K. Chowk, NIT Faridabad, Haryana. ENROL. No. PH/5563/2022
Mobile No.7303834091, Email- lawconsultantsoffice@gmail.com

नीलाभी सूचना

दिए गए कार्यक्रम के अनुसार ‘‘ जो जहाँ है – जैसा है’’ के आधार पर जर्जर भवन एवं कमरों को तोड़ने, सोल्वेज मटेरियल को अधिकार में लेने सहित मौजूदा ढांचे को डिसमेंटिंग सामग्री की स्थल से सकाई के उद्देश्य हेतु निम्न लिखित पुराने व असुरक्षित ईमारत की नीलाभी :-

Sr. No.	Block	Name of School	No. of Unsafe declared rooms	Time limit from date of auction	Reserve price for auction	Place of auction	Date of auction
1.	Tauru	GPS Chahalka	2	1 month	37871	BEO Office TAURU	30/07/2026 2 PM
2.	Tauru	GPS Jaurasi	2	1 month	75493		
3.	Tauru	GPS Pada	4 Room & 1 Kitchen	1 month	211737		
4.	Tauru	GGPS Kalwari	1	1 month	10393		
5.	Tauru	GPS Shikarpur	5	1 month	117617		
6.	Tauru	GPS Dhulawat	2	1 month	59021		
7.	Tauru	GPS Jafrabad	2	1 month	34472		
8.	Tauru	GPS Raniyaki	3	1 month	70769		
9.	NUH	GPS Jogipur	1	1 month	23894	BEO Office NUH	30/07/2026 11 AM
10.	NUH	GSSS Meoli	10 Rooms	1 month	375862		
11.	NUH	GSSS Gangoli	3 Rooms & 1 Kitchen	1 month	65730		
12.	NUH	GSSS Salaheri	8 Rooms HMR, 5 Toilets, Water Tank & 1 Kitchen	1 month	352884		

शर्तें :-

- प्रत्येक बोलीदाता को जिला शिक्षा अधिकारी, नृंह के पक्ष में बैंक ड्राफ्ट के रूप में खण्ड अनुसार स्कूलों की 10प्रतिशत रुपये की राशि (खण्ड नृंह- 81837 रुपये एवं खण्ड तालवृड-61737 रुपये) बोली के लिए योग्यता प्राप्त करने के लिए 2 दिन पूर्व जिला शिक्षा अधिकारी कार्यालय नृंह में श्री सतवीर लिपिक को जमा करवानी होगी जोकि सफल बोलीदाता को छेड़ कर नीलाभी की समाप्ति पर वापिस कर दी जाएगी।
- सफल बोलीदाता को न्यूनतम राशि का 10प्रतिशत जमानत के तौर पर बोली के दिन ही अधोहस्ताक्षरी के पक्ष में ड्राफ्ट के रूप में जमा करवानी होगी। जो कार्य समाप्ति पर वापिस कर दी जाएगी।
- सफल बोलीदाता को बोली राशी का 100प्रतिशत 2 दिन के अन्दर अन्दर उपरोक्त विद्यालय अनुसार सम्बन्धित विद्यालय मुखिया के पक्ष में बैंक ड्राफ्ट / बैंक के माध्यम से जमा करवानी होगी। असफल रहने पर जमा कराई गई बैंक ड्राफ्ट के रूप में जमा 10प्रतिशत रुपये की राशि जब्त कर ली जाएगी।
- ईमारत अनुमोदन जारी के 1 माह में ईमारत तोड़ने जानी चाहिए तथा स्थल सोल्वेज रहित होना चाहिए जिसके असफल रहने पर शेष सोल्वेजपर सरकार द्वारा कब्जा ले लिया जायेगा।
- पार्टियों के मध्य किसी भी विवाद में न्यायिक क्षेत्राधिकार नृंह का होगा
- बोली के समय किसी भी बोलीदाता द्वारा विवाद किया जाता है तो उसकी 10प्रतिशत राशि जब्त कर ली जाएगी एवं बोली में भाग लेने से बर्हित कर दिया जायेगा।
- अगर अपरिहार्य परिस्थितियों के कारण डिसमेंटिंग के लिए ईमारत का कब्जा समय में नहीं दिया जाता है तो छेड़कार को कोई राहत नहीं दी जाएगी। केवल समय बढ़या जायेगा।

नोट :- बोलीदाता बोली व नीलाभी होने से पहले स्थल (विद्यालय की असुरक्षित ईमारत) को देख सकते हैं।

जिला शिक्षा अधिकारी नृंह ।

DIRECTORATE GENERAL OF SUPPLIES AND TRANSPORT, QMG'S BRANCH, INTEGRATED HEADQUARTER'S OF MOD (ARMY) DHQ PO. NEW DELHI-110011
REGISTRATION OF VENDORS AS APPROVED ASC CONTRACTORS

1. Applications are invited for registration as approved ASC Contractors for supply of Meat Dressed/Chicken (Broiler) Dressed- in Frozen/Chilled state to Indian Army. Interested firms/vendors may forward request for further details on email **contracts.56@gov.in**

2. Applications are also invited for registration as approved ASC Contractors for supply of Whole Wheat Flour (Atta), Suji, Refined Wheat Flour (Maida), Dalia, Bran and Hay to Indian Army. Interested firms/vendors may forward request for further details on email **poorti.idst@gov.in**

3. Applications are invited for registration as approved ASC Contractors for supply of dry and tinned items of rations procured centrally [Sugar, Vegetable Ready to Eat, Fruit Dried, Raisin Brown, Cashew Kernel Whole Raw (Grade 240), Almond Without Shell, Fruit Canned in Syrup/Murabba Canned, Jam and Marmalade, Potato Dehydrated, Onion Dehydrated, Vegetable Dehydrated, Vegetable Canned, Pulses (Lobia, Kabli Chana Whole, Rajmah and Peas Dried Green), Survival Ration, Barley Whole/Crushed, Linseed Whole/Crushed, Malted Milk Food/Malt Based Food, Edible Oil, Tea CTC, Soluble Coffee Powder, Fish Canned, Egg Powder (Spray Dried) One Man Meals Ready to Eat (MsRE), Mutton Canned and Chicken Curried without Bones in Retortable Pouches] for Indian Army. Interested firms/vendors may apply on vendor registration app of APO at **https://apovra.gov.in**. Further details if required can be sought on email **apo-mod@nic.in**.

cbc 1602/11/0003/2627

Nehra sir guides me through self-doubt: Pacer Ashok Sharma

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
■ Harare

He might have played just six IPL games for Gujarat Titans but mentorship of head coach Ashish Nehra has certainly helped rookie pacer Ashok Sharma evolve as a potent weapon, ready to be unleashed against Zimbabwe in the upcoming three-match T20I series.

The first match will be played here on Thursday. "Whenever I talk about belief, I think of (Ashish) Nehra sir. I used to go to him with every doubt. Whenever I had any self-doubt or needed to ask something, I would approach him," Ashok, who has just turned 24 last

month, told JioStar. "He (Nehra) had told me once, 'Even if you come to me at midnight with a question, I will be ready for you.' So whenever I had any doubt, whether it was about a delivery or anything related to my bowling, I would go to him.

"After matches, I would go to his room and watch videos of my bowling. I would ask him what more I could perfect and what I needed to work on. I consider him my mentor. I have learned so much from him this IPL season, and he has helped me a lot," said one of India's fastest bowlers, who plays domestic cricket for Rajasthan. Ashok, who clocked 95.8 miles (154.2 km)

for GT during an IPL match against Rajasthan Royals at Motera, is confident of doing well against Zimbabwe but his ultimate aim is to play Test cricket for India.

"My first target will be to wear the India jersey. I am waiting for that moment, to wear that jersey and represent my nation. Now that I am in the squad for the series against Zimbabwe, my next target will be to take as many wickets as possible and try to play as many matches as I can. I want to make this opportunity count.

"My next goal after that will be to play red-ball cricket for India as soon as possible," said Ashok, who has taken 14 wickets in four Ranji Trophy



games. Like many other pacers, Ashok idolises the legendary South African fast bowler Dale Steyn.

"Dale Steyn is a bowler who is a match-winner in himself. On his day, when his bowling was on point, he could win matches single-handedly.

He could take the game away from the opposition in a matter of a few overs. "I follow him in terms of his aggression, his run-up, his intensity, and the way he used to set up batters. Everything about him is inspiring. He is someone I look up to as a fast bowler."

Talking about guidance, it is not just Nehra, who has given priceless advice, but

training with 100-Test veteran Ishant Sharma and India red ball specialist Mohammed Siraj has helped him learn new aspects about his own bowling. "When I joined the Gujarat Titans camp for the first time, Ishant Sharma bhai was standing there. He asked me about my recent performance, how many wickets I had taken in Ranji Trophy and what my figures looked like. I told him, 'Bhaiya, I have 16 wickets in four matches.'

"He said, 'Everything looks good. You are bowling well. But if you work a little more on your length, especially the good length area, those 16 wickets in four matches can easily become 24. Just

focus on hitting that consistent length.'" Siraj also helped him during net sessions, providing solutions whenever he saw any scope for improvement.

"I had a lot of talks with Siraj bhaiya as well. I would discuss all these things with him. Siraj bhaiya would explain everything to me very well. He would stand with me and watch two or three of my deliveries. Then he would tell me, 'Do this, make this change, try this.'

"So I learned a lot from him. I have carried all those learnings with me. Whenever I get time to practice in Jaipur, I focus on those things and try to do them even better," he concluded.

Major restructuring proposed for All India Tennis Association

AMANPREET SINGH
■ New Delhi



The court-appointed administrator, Justice Gita Mittal, has proposed a major restructuring of the All India Tennis Association (AITA), including the induction of five Sportspersons of Outstanding Merit (SOMs) into the Executive Committee and a significant change in the composition of the Central Council by reducing state association representation from two members to one.

Another proposal is to make eight Sportspersons of Outstanding Merit, including four women, voting members of the Central Council, giving athletes a greater role in the federation's decision-making.

The proposed constitution-

al amendments will require approval of AITA members at Sunday's Extraordinary General Meeting before they can be implemented, although the federation is expected to contest some of the recommendations. The proposed amendments, circulated ahead of the EGM,

seek to comprehensively overhaul AITA's constitution to align it with the National Sports Governance Act, 2025.

The biggest structural change is the downsizing of the Executive Committee.

The existing executive, which has around 25 members, will be replaced

by a statutory 15-member body comprising the President, Secretary General, Treasurer, five Sportspersons of Outstanding Merit, two Athletes Committee representatives and five zonal members. At least one-third of the members, including two women sportspersons and one woman athletes' representative, must be women.

The Central Council, which functions as the federation's general body, will also undergo a major restructuring. Instead of every affiliated state association sending two representatives, each affiliate will now nominate one representative. Alongside them, eight Sportspersons of Outstanding Merit will become voting members, while a nominee of the

Paralympic Committee of India will also be inducted into the Council.

The draft constitution introduces the category of "Sportspersons of Outstanding Merit", prescribing a transparent process of public applications and preparation of merit-based rosters for athlete representation in governance.

Justice Mittal has also proposed abolishing the posts of Vice President (Sports) and Senior Vice President/Vice President (Chair), describing them as consequential changes flowing from the governance model prescribed under the Sports Act.

Another proposal is the replacement of the existing Athletes' Commission with a statutory Athletes Committee.

Knowledge transfer as important as medals at Glasgow CWG: Rohit Rajpal

SUMAN RAY ■ New Delhi



India will measure success at the upcoming Glasgow Commonwealth Games not just by medals but by the "knowledge it acquires" ahead of hosting the centenary 2030 edition in Ahmedabad, India's Chef de Mission Rohit Rajpal has said.

The 23rd edition of the quadrennial extravaganza beginning on July 23, have been significantly scaled down, featuring only 10 sports — nine fewer than Birmingham 2022, where India finished fourth with 61 medals (22 gold, 16 silver and 23 bronze).

The non-playing captain of India's Davis Cup team, Rajpal in an interview to PTI said the off-field agenda assumes unprecedented significance so that they leave no stone unturned for 2030.

"This time, both the Games side and the non-Games side are equally

important," Rajpal said from Glasgow after reviewing preparations ahead of the opening ceremony.

"There will be knowledge-transfer programmes on the sidelines so we can match or better things when we host the next Games in India. We will also be taking back the flag and the baton."

Sports Minister Mansukh Mandaviya and senior sports administrators are also

expected in Glasgow to monitor athlete welfare and ensure there are no logistical issues before competition. The Gujarat Chief Minister, Deputy Chief Minister and the state's Sports Secretary are expected to attend as part of India's delegation studying the operational aspects of the Games. India hosted the 2010 CWG in New Delhi, where it recorded a best-ever second-place finish with 101 medals (38-27-36), although the build-up was overshadowed by organisational chaos.

The 55-year-old said Games management has evolved considerably since then. "Technology has come into play. We need to understand all of that very well," he said, pointing to Games management software, integrated control rooms and real-time coordination across multiple venues as key areas of focus." (PTI)

Devika, Prannoy lose on day 1 of China Masters



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
■ Changzhou

Devika Sihag put up a spirited fight before going down in three games, while HS Prannoy bowed out after a straight-game defeat as India endured a disappointing opening day at the USD 2,000,000 China Masters here on Tuesday.

Devika, the Thailand Open Super 300 champion, rallied after dropping the opening game but could not sustain the momentum, losing 19-21,

21-19, 13-21 to World No. 20 Thailand's Busanan Ongbamrungphan in the women's singles opening round. Prannoy, a 2023 World Championships bronze medalist, also lost in the men's opening round after suffering a 10-21, 14-21 defeat to Malaysia's Leong Jun Hao.

Newly-crowned Japan Open winner PV Sindhu will begin her campaign, taking on compatriot Unnati Hooda on Wednesday.

Lakshya Sen and Ayush Shetty too will in action.

India faces crucial test against China ahead of Asian Games

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
■ Hangzhou



The Indian shooting contingent will have one final opportunity to measure itself against the world's best before turning its focus to the Asian Games when it competes at the ISSF World Cup in Hangzhou, China, beginning on Wednesday.

More importantly, the tournament offers India a valuable chance to assess its progress against continental powerhouse China, whose dominance in international shooting continues to set the

benchmark. With the Asian Games in Aichi-Nagoya less than two months away (September 19-October 4), the Hangzhou World Cup

assumes added significance.

Competing in Asia, under conditions similar to those expected at the continental showpiece, will provide

Indian shooters with crucial match practice while also offering a psychological edge if they can challenge the hosts on their home soil. China has once again demonstrated why it remains the sport's dominant force.

At the opening ISSF World Cup of the season in Granada, Spain, the Chinese contingent topped the medals table with eight gold medals, underlining the remarkable depth of its squad across rifle and pistol. India, despite fielding a competitive team, returned with just one gold medal, highlighting the gap it

still needs to bridge before the Asian Games.

The second ISSF World Cup in Munich, however, painted a far more encouraging picture for India. Teen sensation Suruchi Inder Singh picked up where she had left off last season by clinching the women's 10m air pistol title, continuing her meteoric rise after winning four World Cup gold medals in 2025. Asian Games medalist Esha Singh also struck gold in the women's 25m pistol, reaffirming her status as one of India's strongest medal hopes.

Gold difficult but we will do fine in CWG, Asiad not so sure: Mary Kom

POONAM MEHRA
■ New Delhi

Ask her about the current state of Indian boxing and MC Mary Kom is not quite sure how to respond but the six-time world champion is hopeful that the pugilists will deliver a reasonably good medal haul at the Commonwealth Games even though a gold might just elude them.

The six-time world champion and Olympic bronze-medallist (2012) is also a gold-winner at the previous CWG, including three gold and one silver. The contingent for the Glasgow Games, beginning July 23, comprises seven men and as many women.

Expectations are higher from the women's team which features Olympic bronze-medallist Lovlina Borgohain (75kg), world number one Jaismine Lamboria (57kg), Asian Games bronze-medallist Preeti Pawar (54kg) and World Cup gold-medallist Arundhati Chaudhary (70kg). All four of them also fetched podium finishes at the Asian Championships in April this year.

Among the men, Sachin Siwach (60kg) is being rated highly after a silver-winning show at the Asian



chance of being in the finals.

Indian boxers had won seven medals at the previous CWG, including three gold and one silver. The contingent for the Glasgow Games, beginning July 23, comprises seven men and as many women.

Expectations are higher from the women's team which features Olympic bronze-medallist Lovlina Borgohain (75kg), world number one Jaismine Lamboria (57kg), Asian Games bronze-medallist Preeti Pawar (54kg) and World Cup gold-medallist Arundhati Chaudhary (70kg). All four of them also fetched podium finishes at the Asian Championships in April this year.

Among the men, Sachin Siwach (60kg) is being rated highly after a silver-winning show at the Asian

Championships along with Narender Berwal (+90kg), who clinched a bronze at the same event. Berwal had also won a bronze at the previous Asian Games. "I just want to give my best wishes to them. It's not easy to represent India. They are all getting responsibility, not just to participate, you know, they will also think to come back with the medal for the country," Mary Kom, who is no longer eligible to compete in the amateur circuit after crossing the age limit of 40, said. **Don't understand BFI's functioning:** When the topic of conversation shifts to the administrative side of the sport that has relatively faded in public memory after the highs of 2008 and 2012 Olympic campaigns, Mary Kom relies on brevity to express how she feels. (PTI)

India name 20-member squad for Hockey World Cup

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
■ New Delhi

India on Tuesday named a 20-member squad for next month's FIH Men's Hockey World Cup, with four players from the side who featured in the European leg of the Pro League missing out owing to the tournament's squad-size limit.

Defender Amandeep Lakra, midfielders Raj Kumar Pal and Rabichandra Singh Moirangthem, and forward Selvam Karthi were the four players omitted from the 24-member Pro League squad. India endured a disappointing FIH Pro League campaign last month, winning four, drawing five and losing seven matches to finish eighth among nine teams, just above Pakistan.

The side will now look to improve on their recent World Cup record. India finished ninth in the previous edition in 2023 and have not won any medal since claiming their lone title in Kuala Lumpur in 1975. They had earlier secured bronze in



Barcelona in 1971 and silver in Amsterdam in 1973. Ace drag-flicker and defender Harmanpreet Singh, who led India to Olympic bronze medal at the 2024 Paris Games, will captain the side.

Veteran midfielder Manpreet Singh, India's most-capped player, adds experience to a squad blending established stars with promising youngsters. "This is a well-balanced squad — the right mix of tournament experience and in-form youth who've earned their spot through performance, not reputation," chief coach Craig Fulton said.

The goalkeeping department comprises Mohith HS

and Suraj Karkera, while the defensive unit features Jarmanpreet Singh, captain Harmanpreet, Amit Rohidas, Jugraj Singh, Sanjay, Sumit and Yashdeep Siwach.

The midfield will be led by Manpreet, Hardik Singh and Vivek Sagar Prasad, alongside Nilakanta Sharma and youngsters Rajinder Singh and Aditya Arjun Lalage. The forward line consists of Mandeep Singh, Dilpreet Singh, Abhishek, Sukhjeet Singh and Shilanand Lakra.

India have been drawn in Pool D alongside England, Pakistan and Wales, with all their group-stage matches scheduled to be played in Amstelveen, the Netherlands.

Glasgow Diary: City awaits Commonwealth Games buzz as athletes trickle in

APARAJITA UPADHYAY
■ Glasgow

The first signs of the Commonwealth Games appear almost as soon as one steps off the plane. Inside the Glasgow International Airport, athletes in national team tracksuits wait at the conveyer belts for their luggage even as volunteers in

the Games' trademark purple uniforms welcome delegations arriving from across the Commonwealth.

Every few minutes, a team emerges through the arrival gates, adding to the steady stream that will soon swell to nearly 3,000 athletes.

Beyond the airport, however, the atmosphere is subdued. The city centre

carries reminders that Glasgow is about to host one of the world's biggest multi-sport events in just about two days' time. Posters featuring the official mascot, Finnie the Unicorn complete with its distinctive traffic-cone horn stand alongside images of Scotland's leading athletes. A countdown clock greets commuters at Central Station at



Queen Street Station while ticket barriers have been wrapped in Games branding. However, beyond these pockets, Glasgow continues at its familiar pace.

For now, there is little to suggest that an international sporting event is around the corner. Glasgow stepped in only after Australia's Victoria state withdrew from

hosting because of spiralling costs, forcing organisers to rethink the event. The result is a significantly scaled-back Games featuring just 10 sports — the fewest since the 1994 edition, spread across four venues: the Scottish Event Campus, Glasgow Arena, Scotstoun Stadium and Tollcross International Swimming

Centre. "I knew the Commonwealth Games were happening because they came to my university looking for volunteers," University of Glasgow student Nathan MacKenzie told PTI.

"But after that I haven't really followed it. It's only now that the posters have started appearing in the city centre," he added.